NAṢĪR AL-DĪN AL-ṬŪSĪ

Tajrīd al-iʿtiqād

Complete English translation

With explanatory notes drawn from
al-Ḥillī's Kashf al-murād

Revised working translation

Prepared for Sachi
28 October 2026

About this edition

This edition contains the same complete English translation as the revised Arabic–English volume. It adds fuller notes on difficult arguments, chiefly by explaining how al-Ḥillī reads Ṭūsī's compressed text. It is intended for continuous reading and close study alongside the bilingual edition.

The main text translates Ṭūsī. The footnotes identify interpretive choices, textual differences, and explanations drawn from al-Ḥillī's Kashf al-murād. They are selective paraphrases, not a complete translation of the commentary. Where al-Ḥillī offers alternatives or disagrees with Ṭūsī, the notes preserve that distinction.

Arabic in square brackets gives the corresponding technical term, normally at its first occurrence in each numbered passage and each footnote. The Arabic is given in a standard lexical form. English in square brackets marks wording supplied in translation. The 836 reference numbers are identical in both editions; §1 is displayed as 1a for the preface and 1b for the opening argument. Black division and chapter headings reproduce the source structure. Muted green headings are editorial reading aids.

The controlling text is the matn embedded in the Āmulī edition of Kashf al-murād. Source page references in the explanatory notes belong to that edition. Selected passages have been checked against al-Jalālī's standalone edition. The full 2025 Naqavi edition and the manuscripts have not been collated for this translation.

This edition sets the complete English translation and notes in two columns on portrait A4 pages, with narrow margins for printing.

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Source coverage in the Āmulī edition: I, pp.20–135; II, pp.136–279; III, pp.280–344; IV, pp.345–360; V, pp.361–398; VI, pp.399–428.

Author’s preface

§1a In the name of God, the Merciful, the Compassionate.

After praising the Necessary Existent [واجب الوجود] for His blessings, and invoking blessings upon the foremost of His prophets, Muḥammad the Chosen, and upon the most honoured of His trusted ones, I respond to the request that I formulate the questions of kalām precisely and arrange them in the most effective order, pointing to the choice benefits of belief and the subtleties of questions of independent inquiry, in accordance with what proof has led me to and upon which my conviction has become firm. I have entitled it The Abstract of Belief (Tajrīd al-iʿtiqād). I ask God for protection from error and for correctness, and that He make it a provision for me on the Day of Return. I have arranged it in divisions.[1]

[1] §1. The Arabic umanā’ is rendered ‘trusted ones’. The controlling recension reads ‘my conviction’ (iʿtiqādī); al-Jalālī, p.101, and the public Arabic preview of Naqavi’s 2025 edition read ‘my reliance’ (iʿtimādī). The preface and the opening division and chapter headings occur in this first source block.

Division 1
General matters

This division comprises chapters.

Chapter 1 · Existence and nonexistence

§1b Defining them as ‘that whose entity is established’ and ‘that whose entity is negated’, or as ‘that about which information can be given’ and its opposite, or in other such ways, involves an evident circle [الدور الظاهر]. §2 Rather, the intention is to explain the expression, for nothing is better known than existence [الوجود].

§3 Arguing [for its indefinability] from the dependence upon it of assent [التصديق] to incompatibility, or from a thing’s dependence upon itself, or from the noncomposition of existence [الوجود] while supposing it [composite], or by invalidating descriptive definition [الرسم], is unsound.[2]

The common meaning of existence

§4 The following establish that [existence] [الوجود] has a common meaning: the mind’s hesitation [about what a thing is] while remaining certain of existence without qualification; the unity of the concept of its contradictory; and its admitting division.[3]

Existence and quiddity

§5 It therefore differs from quiddity [الماهية]; otherwise quiddities would be identical, or their constituent parts would have no limit. §6 Also because the two can be separated in thought; §7 because possibility in the strict sense [الإمكان الخاص] is realised; §8 because predication [الحمل] is informative; §9 because [affirming existence] [الوجود] requires inference;

§10 because [denying existence [الوجود] of a quiddity] [الماهية] entails no contradiction [التناقض]; §11 and because [otherwise] the Necessary would be composite.

§12 It subsists in quiddity [الماهية] insofar as it is itself.[4]

§13 Its being additional [to quiddity] [الماهية] is thus in conception [التصور].

Mental and external existence

§14 It divides into mental and external [existence] [الوجود]; otherwise [real propositions] would be invalid.[5]

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[2] §3. Ṭūsī rejects these arguments for the indefinability of existence [الوجود], not the conclusion that existence is indefinable. Al-Ḥillī reconstructs two proofs attributed to Fakhr al-Dīn. The first moves from the self-evidence of the incompatibility of existence and nonexistence [العدم] to the alleged self-evidence of their concepts. Al-Ḥillī replies that a self-evident judgment can depend on an acquired conception [التصور]; moreover, the partial conception sufficient for judging need not be the complete conception sought through definition. The second proof attempts to exclude definition through the thing itself, its constituents, or an external property. Against it, al-Ḥillī argues that the proposed objection to composition would undermine composite quiddities [الماهية] generally. A descriptive property must actually be coextensive with what it defines, but the learner need not already know that coextension. Thus the alleged circularity does not follow merely from using such a property. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 22.)

[3] §4. Al-Ḥillī identifies three arguments for a meaning shared across applications of “existence [الوجود]”. First, one can infer an existing cause from an observed effect while remaining uncertain whether that cause is contingent or necessary. Changing that further belief need not remove the original judgment that the cause exists. Second, the negative counterpart has one concept, so its contradictory must likewise have a common concept if affirmation and negation are to divide the alternatives exhaustively. Third, existence admits intelligible divisions into necessary and contingent, substance [الجوهر] and accident [العرض], or mental and external. Such division requires a common term applicable to its members: “animal” can divide into human and horse, but not into human and stone. This common meaning does not establish identical natures or equal predication [الحمل] in every case; §38 expressly discusses unequal, analogical predication [التشكيك]. As an editorial caution, this should not automatically be identified with later Ṣadrian doctrines of the gradation of existence. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 24, 41.)

[4] §12. The objection reconstructed by al-Ḥillī assumes that, if existence [الوجود] is additional to quiddity [الماهية], it must inhere in a quiddity already either existent or nonexistent. The first option seems to require a prior existence, inviting circularity or regress; the second seems to put an existent attribute into a nonexistent subject. Ṭūsī rejects the exhaustiveness of that division: the relevant consideration is quiddity as such, without first qualifying it by either alternative. Al-Ḥillī's explanation of the following clause makes the restriction explicit. This additionality is grasped in conception [التصور], not as an external accident [العرض] added to an independently existing quiddity. He contrasts it with blackness inhering in a subject. The passage therefore does not posit a third external condition between existence and nonexistence [العدم]; it distinguishes what is included in considering the quiddity from what accompanies its external realisation. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 27.)

[5] §14. The received lemma prints al-ḥaqīqa; al-Ḥillī explains its force through “real propositions” (qaḍāyā ḥaqīqiyya). The bracketed English follows that explanation without silently changing the Arabic. His argument begins from affirmative judgments whose subjects need not exist externally. Affirming a feature requires its subject to be established in some respect; where external establishment is absent, the subject is established in thought. He distinguishes taking a subject according to what it is from restricting it to its external instances. The proposed mental existence [الوجود الذهني] supplies a subject for such judgment, rather than turning every conceived thing into an externally existing object. The reader should consequently distinguish the proposition's truth from the external existence [الوجود الخارجي] of a presently instantiated subject: the argument is directed against the restriction of all existence [الوجود] to external existence. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 28.)

§15 What exists in the mind is only the form [الصورة], which differs [from its external instance] in many concomitants.

Existence as realisation

§16 Existence [الوجود] is not a meaning by which quiddity [الماهية] is realised externally; it is that realisation itself.

Increase and intensification

§17 It admits neither increase nor intensification.

The goodness of existence

§18 It is pure good.

Existence has no contrary

§19 It has no contrary [الضد].

Existence has no like

§20 Nor has it a like.

Existence and other intelligibles

§21 Its difference from [other] intelligibles [المعقول] is thereby established. §22 Yet it is not incompatible with them.

Existence and thingness

§23 It is coextensive with thingness [الشيئية] (shay'iyya), which is therefore not realised without it. Whoever disputes this resists the deliverance of his own reason.

§24 How could [thingness] [الشيئية] be realised without it, while effective power [القدرة] is affirmed and qualification [as an additional external entity] is denied?[6]

§25 And [how could this be so] given the finitude of what exists and the unintelligibility of anything additional [to external being]? §26 If differentiation entailed establishment [الثبوت] externally, impossibilities would follow. §27 Possibility [الإمكان] is conceptual, and it applies to things whose absence [externally] they concede to us.

The rejection of states

§28 Existence [الوجود] is synonymous with establishment [الثبوت] (thubūt), and nonexistence [العدم] with negation; there is therefore no intermediate [state] [الحال].[7]

§29 Existence [الوجود] does not admit the [proposed] division; the universal [الكلي] is established mentally; and an accident [العرض] may subsist in an accident. §30 They are also refuted by the state [الحال] (ḥāl) itself. §31 The excuses that [states] [الحال] admit neither likeness nor difference, and that an infinite regress [التسلسل] may be accepted, are unsound.

Consequences of nonexistent essences and states

§32 Thus what they build upon the two [doctrines] is invalid: the realisation of infinitely many essences [الذات] in nonexistence [العدم]; the absence of an efficient cause [المؤثر]'s influence upon them and of differentiation among them; their disagreement over affirming the generic attribute and what follows it in existence [الوجود]; spatial occupancy [التحيز]'s difference from substantiality [الجوهرية]; affirming an attribute of the nonexistent in virtue of its being nonexistent; the possibility [الإمكان] of describing it as corporeal; and doubt about the Maker's existence after ascribing power [القدرة], knowledge [العلم], and life to Him.[8] §33 Likewise [invalid are] dividing states [الحال] into caused and uncaused, explaining difference by them, and other matters whose mention brings no benefit.

Unqualified and qualified existence

§34 Existence [الوجود] may be considered without qualification, in which case a corresponding nonexistence [العدم] opposes it. The two may be combined when not considered as opposites, and both are intelligible [المعقول]. It may also be considered with a qualification, in which case a correspondingly qualified [nonexistence] opposes it.

The subject of privation

§35 [Privation] [عدم الملكة] requires a subject [الموضوع], just as its corresponding possession [الملكة] does. §36 The subject [الموضوع] may be considered individually, specifically, or generically.

The simplicity of existence

§37 Existence [الوجود] has no genus [الجنس]. Rather, it is simple, and so has no differentia [الفصل].

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[6] §24. Al-Ḥillī treats this as an argument against opponents who affirm established essences even while those essences do not exist. On their account, power [القدرة] does not produce the essences themselves, because those are already established; nor does it produce existence [الوجود], because existence is classified as a state not subject to production. A third candidate would be the essence's being qualified by existence. Al-Ḥillī denies that this qualification is a further external entity: treating it as one would require another qualification explaining its own establishment, and so on. The combination therefore leaves effective power with nothing upon which to act, contrary to the power the opponents admit. The conclusion is directed against that combination of premises. It does not deny meaningful predication [الحمل], and it does not make the inefficacy of power Ṭūsī's own positive doctrine. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 32.)

[7] §28. Thubūt [الثبوت] is kept distinct in translation even where Ṭūsī explicitly equates its extension with existence [الوجود]. The rejected intermediate is the technical ḥāl of the theory of states [الحال].

[8] §32. This is a compressed list of consequences and disputes within the doctrines under criticism, not a list of Ṭūsī's own positive theses. Al-Ḥillī takes the negation to include differentiation between essences [الذات] themselves; differentiation is instead assigned to attributes accruing to them.

Graded predication of existence

§38 It is multiplied with the multiplicity of its subjects [الموضوع] and is predicated analogically [التشكيك] of the [particular existences] that accrue to them.[9]

§39 It is therefore not a constituent of anything else at all.

Thingness

§40 Thingness [الشيئية] is among the second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية] and is not independently rooted in existence [الوجود]. No 'thing without qualification' is therefore established [as such]; rather, [thingness] applies to the specific quiddities [الماهية].[10]

Differentiation among nonexistences

§41 Nonexistences can be differentiated. Thus the nonexistence [العدم] of an effect [المعلول] depends upon the nonexistence of its cause [العلة], and not upon another [nonexistence]; the absence of a condition is incompatible with the existence [الوجود] of what is conditioned; and the absence of a contrary [الضد] makes the other contrary's existence possible, unlike other absences. §42 Nonexistence [العدم] may itself be subject to nonexistence; thus being a species [of nonexistence] and being opposed [to nonexistence] are true of it in two different respects.

§43 The nonexistence [العدم] of the effect [المعلول] is not a cause [العلة] of the nonexistence of the cause externally, although [the inference] is permissible mentally as a demonstration from effect to cause [البرهان الإني] (innī). The reverse is a demonstration from cause to effect [البرهان اللمي] (limmī).

Generality and nonexistence

§44 Things ordered by greater and lesser generality in existence [الوجود] have the reverse order in nonexistence [العدم].

Dependence and independence

§45 Existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] each divide exclusively and exhaustively into dependent and independent.[11]

Necessity possibility and impossibility

§46 When existence [الوجود] is predicated or made a copula, three modal matters [المادة] are established in themselves. In thought they are modalities [الجهة], indicating the firmness or weakness of the connection: necessity [الوجوب] (wujūb), impossibility [الامتناع] (imtināʿ), and possibility [الإمكان] (imkān).[12]

§47 The same applies to nonexistence [العدم].

Defining the three modalities

§48 The discussion of defining these is like that concerning existence [الوجود].

The threefold modal division

§49 They may be considered intrinsic; the division is then exclusive and exhaustive, and [a thing's intrinsic modal status] cannot change.[13]

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[9] §38. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes the one intelligible [المعقول] concept of existence [الوجود] from the particular existences associated with different quiddities [الماهية]. Since one numerically individual attribute cannot belong to several subjects [الموضوع], existence considered in relation to one subject is distinguished from existence considered in relation to another. The common concept is predicated of these particular existences. He then distinguishes equal predication [الحمل] from predication involving priority, precedence, or greater intensity. A cause's existence is prior to its effect's and has the stronger claim to the common character. Significantly, the further attribution of greater intensity is presented as the view of some thinkers. "Analogically" should therefore not be reduced to "in stronger and weaker degrees" alone. The passage explains how a common intelligible meaning can apply unequally without collapsing the particular existences into one numerically identical external item. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 41.)

[10] §40. The denial concerns a separately established 'thing as such', not the existence [الوجود] of particular things.

[11] §45. Ḥaqīqiyya here is a logical term: the alternatives are both exhaustive and mutually exclusive.

[12] §46. The two opening cases concern existence [الوجود] as a predicate, as in "a human exists", and the existential connection between subject and predicate, as in saying that a human is an animal. Al-Ḥillī calls the connection's status as it is in itself its modal matter [المادة] (mādda); its status as thought or expressed is its modality [الجهة] (jiha). These can agree, but need not. His example contrasts expressing the necessary connection between humanity and animality as necessary with expressing it as possible: the expressed modality does not change the connection's underlying matter. Necessity [الوجوب] signifies firmness on the affirmative side, impossibility [الامتناع] firmness on the negative side, and possibility [الإمكان] a weaker connection. "Matter" here is consequently a term of modal logic, not the material constituent of a physical body. The distinction also prevents the form of an utterance from being confused with the relation it describes. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 45.)

[13] §49. Al-Ḥillī explains a "real" division here as one that permits neither overlap nor omission: every intelligible [المعقول] object is intrinsically necessary, intrinsically impossible, or intrinsically possible, and no object falls into two of these classes in the same consideration. Its inability to "change" concerns passage from one intrinsic classification to another. It does not mean that an intrinsically possible thing cannot acquire or lose existence [الوجود]. The next clause changes the consideration to necessity and impossibility through another. A change in the presence of the cause can change that status while intrinsic possibility [الإمكان الذاتي] remains. Accordingly, intrinsic possibility can accompany either necessity through another [الوجوب بالغير] or impossibility through another. The three descriptions are then exhaustive among contingent things [الممكن] without being mutually exclusive as a set. Necessity through another and impossibility through another nevertheless remain incompatible with one another in the same consideration. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 46–47.)

§50 The first two may be considered through another. Their division is then mutually exclusive [but not exhaustive], and [a thing's status in it] may change; among contingent things [الممكن], the three form an exhaustive [but not mutually exclusive] division.

Kinds of necessity and possibility

§51 Necessity [الوجوب] and impossibility [الامتناع] share the designation 'necessity [الضرورة]' (ḍarūra), although they differ by negation and affirmation. §52 Each is true of the other when their correlates are opposite [as in necessity of existence [وجوب الوجود] and impossibility [الامتناع] of nonexistence] [العدم]. §53 Possibility [الإمكان] may be taken as the negation of necessity [الضرورة] from one of the two sides; it then includes the other necessity and possibility in the strict sense [الإمكان الخاص]. §54 It may also be considered with reference to the future. §55 Nonexistence [العدم] in the present is not a condition [of this future possibility] [الإمكان]; otherwise contradictories would be combined.

The conceptual character of modalities

§56 The three are conceptual considerations, since they are true of the nonexistent and an infinite regress [التسلسل] is impossible. §57 If necessity [الوجوب] were an externally established thing, the Necessary would be contingent. §58 If impossibility [الامتناع] were an externally established thing, the impossible would be possible. §59 If possibility [الإمكان] were an externally established thing, every contingent thing [الممكن]'s existence [الوجود] would precede its possibility. §60 The difference between negating possibility [الإمكان] and possibility that is negated does not entail its external establishment [الثبوت].

Intrinsic and extrinsic modalities

§61 Necessity [الوجوب] encompasses what is intrinsic and what is through another; the same holds for impossibility [الامتناع]. §62 What is subject to either of them through another is intrinsically contingent. §63 There is no 'possible through another', given what preceded concerning the exclusive and exhaustive division.

Modalities and quiddity

§64 Possibility [الإمكان] applies when existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] are left out of consideration with respect to both the quiddity [الماهية] and its cause [العلة]. §65 When they are considered with respect to these two, [necessity [الوجوب] or impossibility] [الامتناع] through another is established. §66 There is no incompatibility between possibility [الإمكان] and [necessity [الوجوب] or impossibility] [الامتناع] through another. §67 Whatever can possibly inhere [in another] is intrinsically possible, but the converse does not hold.[14]

The ground of dependence on a cause

§68 When the mind considers a contingent thing [الممكن] as existent, it seeks its cause [العلة] even without conceiving anything else. It may conceive an originated thing [الحادث]'s existence [الوجود] [if hypothetically taken as intrinsically necessary] without seeking [a cause]. Moreover, origination [الحدوث] is a manner of existence, so cannot cause what precedes it by several ranks.[15]

The contingent needs a cause

§69 The judgment that a contingent thing [الممكن] requires [a cause] [العلة] is non-inferential [الضروري].

The necessity conferred by a cause

§70 No priority [الأولوية] of either side [existence [الوجود] or nonexistence] [العدم] can be conceived by considering the thing's essence [الذات] alone. §71 Nor is an external priority [الأولوية] sufficient: supposing it does not make the opposite impossible. One must therefore arrive at necessity [الوجوب]. §72 This [necessity] [الوجوب] is antecedent. Another necessity follows [existence] [الوجود], and no proposition of actuality is without it. §73 Possibility [الإمكان] is inseparable [from a contingent quiddity] [الماهية]; otherwise the quiddity would become necessary or impossible. §74 The necessity [الوجوب] belonging to propositions of actuality accompanies the possibility [الجواز] of nonexistence [العدم], and is therefore not inseparable [from the quiddity] [الماهية].

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[14] §67. 'Possible inherence' concerns the possibility [الإمكان] of something's belonging to another; it must not be collapsed into intrinsic possibility [الإمكان الذاتي]. Al-Ḥillī gives immaterial entities and necessary concomitant attributes as cases defeating the converse.

[15] §68. The issue is what grounds a thing's dependence on a cause [العلة]: intrinsic possibility [الإمكان الذاتي], temporal origination [الحدوث], or their combination. Al-Ḥillī supports the first answer. Considering a quiddity [الماهية] as indifferent in itself to existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] suffices to require a cause for either determination; no further consideration of its beginning in time is needed. Conversely, he asks the reader hypothetically to suppose an originated thing [الحادث] whose existence is intrinsically necessary, expressly acknowledging that this supposition is impossible. Under that supposition the ground of dependence would be absent. It is not permission to affirm an actual uncaused originated being. The final argument concerns explanatory priority: the ground of dependence precedes dependence, which precedes producing existence; existence in turn precedes its qualification as originated. Origination cannot therefore ground a dependence already presupposed several stages earlier. This ordering concerns dependence, not a sequence of elapsed moments. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 53.)

§75 Necessity [الوجوب] stands to possibility [الإمكان] as completeness to deficiency.

Dispositional possibility

§76 Dispositional possibility [الإمكان الاستعدادي] admits strength and weakness; it ceases to exist and comes to exist in composites, and it differs from intrinsic possibility [الإمكان الذاتي].[16]

Eternity and origination

§77 An existent, considered as unpreceded by another or by nonexistence [العدم], is eternal [القديم] (qadīm); otherwise it is originated [الحادث] (ḥādith).[17] §78 Priority [السبق] and its two counterparts [posteriority and simultaneity] are either in respect of causality [العلية], nature, time, sensible or intelligible rank, excellence, or essence [الذات]. This enumeration rests on induction [الاستقراء].

Graded predication of priority

§79 [Priority] [السبق] is predicated analogically [التشكيك], and the correlation between the two correlates is preserved throughout the kinds of [analogical predication]. §80 Where such gradation occurs, [priority] [السبق] cannot be a genus [الجنس]. §81 Priority [التقدم] always occurs through some temporal, spatial, or other concomitant. §82 Eternity [القدم] and origination [الحدوث] in their proper senses do not include time in their consideration; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow. §83 Essential origination [الحدوث الذاتي] is realised.

§84 Eternity [القدم] and origination [الحدوث] are two intellectual considerations that cease when the consideration ceases. §85 They form an exclusive and exhaustive disjunction.

Properties of the Necessary

§86 The same holds of intrinsic necessity [الوجوب الذاتي] and necessity through another [الوجوب بالغير] [as a division of every existent]. §87 Intrinsic [necessity] [الوجوب] cannot be true of a composite. §88 Nor can what is intrinsically [necessary] be a constituent of something else.

The existence and necessity of the Necessary

§89 Its existence [الوجود] and its relation [النسبة] [of necessity] [الوجوب] are not additional to it; otherwise it would be contingent.

§90 The existence [الوجود] that is known is what is predicated analogically, not the existence proper to Him.[18]

§91 Existence [الوجود] is not a specific nature, as already explained; its instances can therefore differ as to whether it is predicated as additional or not. §92 It is unintelligible that quiddity [الماهية] as such should produce existence [الوجود]. §93 The counterexample drawn from the recipient is plainly invalid. §94 Existence [الوجود] is among intellectual predicates, because it can neither be independent of a substrate [المحل] nor occur in one [as an additional external accident] [العرض].[19] §95 It is among the second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية].

§96 The same holds of nonexistence [العدم]; §97 of their modalities; §98 of quiddity [الماهية]; §99 of universality [الكلية] and particularity [الجزئية]; §100 of essentiality and accidentality [العرضية];

§101 and of genericity [الجنسية], differentiality [الفصلية], and specificity.

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[16] §76. Intrinsic possibility [الإمكان الذاتي] considers the quiddity [الماهية] itself; dispositional possibility [الإمكان الاستعدادي] considers its readiness for realisation. Al-Ḥillī explains the latter through differences in nearness to an outcome. His developmental examples distinguish an earlier stage's remote readiness for humanity or writing from the closer readiness of a later stage. Such readiness can increase, weaken, arise, or disappear. In his physical example, heating water gives it a disposition to become air, while cooling removes that disposition. These examples describe the commentator's account of preparation, not a change in whether the quiddity is intrinsically possible. The point of the final contrast is therefore precise: an acquired disposition can cease while intrinsic possibility does not. The two should not be merged merely because English can describe both an intrinsically possible event and an increasingly prepared process as "possible". (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 56.)

[17] §77. Qidam and ḥudūth are subsequently distinguished according to kinds of priority. 'Eternal [القديم]' here includes the discussion of being unpreceded by a cause, and is not throughout merely a statement about infinite past time.

[18] §90. Al-Ḥillī identifies an objection: humans know existence [الوجود] but do not know God's essence, so existence must differ from that essence. The answer distinguishes the common concept of existence from the existence proper to a particular existent. What is readily conceived and predicated analogically is the former; grasping it does not amount to grasping the particular reality to which it applies. Al-Ḥillī compares a shared description of whiteness with the differing whitenesses of snow and ivory. Sharing a concomitant concept does not make the realities sharing it identical, nor does knowledge [العلم] of that concomitant give exhaustive knowledge of each reality. Thus the objection establishes a distinction between the divine reality and the common concept of existence, rather than between God and His proper existence. The point is not that the assertion that God exists is unintelligible, but that this assertion does not disclose His particular reality. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 63.)

[19] §94. The argument denies that existence [الوجود] is an additional externally inhering item alongside its subject. It does not assert that nothing exists outside thought.

Conceiving nonexistence

§102 The intellect [العقل] can consider two contradictories and judge them to contradict one another; there is no impossibility [الاستحالة] in this.

§103 It can also conceive the nonexistence [العدم] of all things, even its own nonexistence and the nonexistence of nonexistence, by representing [nonexistence] in the mind and negating it. [This negation] is established in one respect and an opposed alternative in another. No judgment can be made about it precisely insofar as it is not established; there is no contradiction [التناقض].[20]

§104 Thus we divide the existent into what is established in the mind and what is not, and judge the two to be distinct. This does not require an identity for each of the things distinguished. Were an identity posited for [the latter], it would have the same status as what is established.

§105 When the mind predicates external matters of external matters, a correct judgment must correspond [to what is external]; otherwise this is not required. Its correctness then consists in correspondence to the matter as it is in itself [نفس الأمر] (nafs al-amr), since falsehoods too can be conceived.[21]

Predicating existence and nonexistence

§106 Existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] may be predicated, or they may connect predicates [to subjects] [الموضوع]. §107 Predication [الحمل] requires the two terms to be identical in one respect and different in another. The respect of identity may be one of the two, or a third. §108 Difference does not require either to subsist in the other. Even if it did, such subsistence would not require the absence of what subsists [to be included in considering its subject] [الموضوع]. §109 Affirming the existence [الوجود] of quiddity [الماهية] does not require quiddity to exist beforehand. §110 Denying its existence [الوجود] does not require its differentiation and establishment [الثبوت]. It is the negation of it, rather than the affirmation of a negation as belonging to it. Its establishment in the mind, though consequent, is not a condition.

§111 Predication [الحمل] and subjecthood [الوضع] are second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية] and are predicated analogically [التشكيك]. Being qualified [by a predicate] is not an externally established entity; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow.

Existence per se and per accidens

§112 Existence [الوجود] may be per se [بالذات] or per accidens [بالعرض]. §113 As for existence [الوجود] in writing or speech, that is figurative.

Restoration after nonexistence

§114 What has ceased to exist cannot be restored [as numerically the same], since it cannot be pointed to; one therefore cannot judge that its restoration [الإعادة] is possible.[22]

§115 If it were restored, nonexistence [العدم] would intervene between a thing and itself. §116 No difference would remain between it and what is newly originated. §117 Opposite determinations would be true of it at once. §118 An infinite

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[20] §103. Al-Ḥillī separates what a conception [التصور] represents from the fact that the conception is present in the mind. The mind can represent the nonexistence [العدم] of things, its own nonexistence, and even the removal of the represented concept of nonexistence. None of this requires those represented absences to be externally existing objects. A concept representing the removal of all establishment is nevertheless mentally established insofar as it is conceived. In its intended content it opposes establishment; as a conception it belongs among things established in thought. These are different considerations, not simultaneous affirmation and denial of the same predicate in the same respect. The restriction on judgment concerns the object precisely insofar as it is not established at all. It is not a blanket prohibition on thinking or making judgments about nonexistent things; such judgment takes its object insofar as that object is conceived. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 68.)

[21] §105. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes judgments about external things as external from judgments involving conceptual considerations, such as possibility [الإمكان] or its opposition to impossibility. The former must correspond to external reality. For the latter, mere conformity to a mental representation cannot establish truth, since false judgments can also be represented. Nafs al-amr, rendered "the matter as it is in itself [نفس الأمر]", names the required standard without reducing it to whatever one happens to think. The commentary then records a conversation with Ṭūsī: when asked what this standard is, Ṭūsī identified it with the Active Intellect [العقل الفعال]. Al-Ḥillī objects that the philosophical account of retaining and recovering judgments would also require false judgments to be represented there, and reports that he received no convincing answer. That discussion belongs to the commentary, not the lemma. The translation therefore neither inserts "Active Intellect" into Ṭūsī's sentence nor conceals the commentator's unresolved objection. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 69.)

[22] §114. The issue is restoration [الإعادة] of the numerically identical thing after its complete cessation, not merely production of something resembling it. Al-Ḥillī reports disagreement and endorses the denial of such restoration, but he does not accept every argument for it without criticism. This first argument claims that the nonexistent retains no distinguishing identity and so cannot be the subject of a judgment that restoration is possible. Al-Ḥillī immediately points out that the same reasoning would also prohibit judging its restoration impossible. His own clarification is that judgment requires mental presence rather than external existence [الوجود الخارجي]. That criticism concerns this proof; it does not mean he has adopted the opposing conclusion about restoration. The passage must also be read alongside Division VI's defense of bodily resurrection through reassembly of the original parts. The present claim about complete cessation should not be turned into a denial of resurrection. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 73, 402, 405–406.)

regress [التسلسل] in time would also follow. §119 The judgment that restoration [الإعادة] is impossible rests upon something inseparable from the quiddity [الماهية] [under the relevant qualification].[23]

Necessary and contingent existents

§120 The division of the existent into necessary and contingent is non-inferential [الضروري]. It applies to existence [الوجود] insofar as existence admits qualification and the absence of qualification.

Judging possibility

§121 Judging that a contingent thing [الممكن]'s existence [الوجود] is possible is a judgment about the quiddity [الماهية] without considering existence or nonexistence [العدم]. §122 Possibility [الإمكان] may be an instrument of intellection [التعقل], or it may itself be intelligible [المعقول] as an object in its own right.

§123 The mind's judgment that a contingent thing [الممكن] is possible is an intellectual consideration; its correspondence to what is in the intellect [العقل] must therefore be considered.[24]

The immediacy of the judgment of dependence

§124 The judgment that a contingent thing [الممكن] requires [a cause] [العلة] is non-inferential [الضروري]. The obscurity of assent [التصديق] due to the obscurity of conception [التصور] does not impair this. §125 Causal efficacy [المؤثرية] is an intellectual consideration. §126 The efficient cause [المؤثر] produces the effect [الأثر] neither insofar as the effect is existent nor insofar as it is nonexistent. §127 Its influence is upon the quiddity [الماهية], and consequent necessity [الوجوب اللاحق] follows it. §128 The nonexistence [العدم] of a contingent thing [الممكن] depends upon the nonexistence of its cause [العلة], as already explained.

Dependence throughout persistence

§129 A contingent thing [الممكن] that persists requires an efficient cause [المؤثر], because the ground [of its need] remains present. §130 The efficient cause [المؤثر] confers persistence after origination [الإحداث]. §131 Consequently, if an eternal [القديم] contingent thing [الممكن] were possible, it could depend upon a necessitating efficient cause [المؤثر الموجب]; it could not depend upon an agent acting by choice [الفاعل المختار].[25]

No second eternal existent

§132 There is nothing eternal [القديم] besides God Most High, as will be shown.

Duration and matter before origination

§133 An originated thing [الحادث] does not require a preceding duration and matter [المادة]; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow.

The impossibility of an eternal existent ceasing

§134 What is eternal [القديم] cannot cease to exist, because it is either intrinsically necessary or depends upon what is.

Chapter 2 · Quiddity and its concomitants

§135 'Quiddity [الماهية]' (māhiyya) derives from 'what is it?' (mā huwa), and is that by which the question 'What is it?' is answered. It is most often applied to what is conceived. 'Essence [الذات]' (dhāt) and 'reality [الحقيقة]' (ḥaqīqa) apply to it with existence [الوجود] taken into account. All are second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية]. §136 The reality [الحقيقة] of each thing is one, and differs from the considerations that attach to it; otherwise it could not be true of what conflicts with those considerations. §137 Quiddity [الماهية] together with any accompanying attribute is opposed to quiddity together with that attribute's opposite.

§138 Quiddity [الماهية], considered as itself, is nothing but itself. If the question is posed in terms of the two contradictories, the answer negates each [additional determination], placing the negation before the 'qua' qualification, not after it.[26]

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[23] §119. Al-Ḥillī explains the qualification as a quiddity [الماهية] that has become nonexistent after existing. Without that qualification the sentence would misleadingly suggest that the thing could never have existed initially.

[24] §123. This wording should remain visible beside §105, where correspondence to a representation in the mind was rejected as a sufficient criterion of truth: falsehood too can be conceived. Here Ṭūsī calls the modal judgment an intellectual consideration and requires attention to its correspondence to what is in the intellect [العقل]. Al-Ḥillī's short explanation repeats that requirement because possibility [الإمكان] is intellectual, referring back to the earlier discussion of when correspondence is relevant. He does not supply a detailed reconciliation in this local passage. One can therefore distinguish the mental status of the concept being considered from the separate question of what makes a judgment true, but should not claim that this distinction fully resolves the compressed wording. The translation retains both formulations rather than silently replacing "what is in the intellect" with nafs al-amr or treating every mentally represented modal claim as true. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 69, 77.)

[25] §131. This is a conditional causal analysis, immediately followed by the denial of any eternal [القديم] existent other than God. It should not be read as Ṭūsī affirming an eternal contingent cosmos.

[26] §138. The position of negation determines what is being denied. Al-Ḥillī's model is "A human is not, insofar as human, A", rather than "A human, insofar as human, is not-A". The first denies that the further determination belongs to humanity simply through being humanity; the second risks making the negative determination part of what

Kinds of universal

§139 Quiddity [الماهية] may be taken with everything besides itself excluded, so that anything joined to it would be additional and it would not be predicable of the resulting whole. This is quiddity 'on condition that nothing [be added]' (bi-sharṭ lā shay'), and it exists only in minds.

§140 It may also be taken 'without any condition' (lā bi-sharṭ shay'). This is the natural universal [الكلي الطبيعي], which exists externally, is a constituent of individuals, and is predicable of the whole formed from it and what is added to it.[27]

§141 The universality [الكلية] attaching to quiddity [الماهية] is called the logical universal [الكلي المنطقي], and the composite of the two the intellectual universal [الكلي العقلي]. Both are mental. These, then, are three considerations that should be distinguished in every intelligible [المعقول] quiddity.

Simple and composite quiddities

§142 Some quiddities [الماهية] are simple, having no constituent part; others are composite, having constituent parts. The existence [الوجود] of both is evident. §143 Their two attributes [simplicity [البساطة] and composition] [التركيب] are conceptual and incompatible. They may also be taken correlatively; compared with their earlier senses, the relations [النسبة] of greater and lesser generality are then reversed. §144 Just as dependence is realised in the composite, so it is in the simple. §145 Both may subsist by themselves, or may require a substrate [المحل].

§146 A composite is composed only of what precedes it in existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم], with respect to both mind and external reality [الخارج]. This [priority] [التقدم] grounds [the constituent's] independence of a [further] cause [السبب]: mentally, [its belonging] is evident; externally, it requires no [further cause]. Three properties thus result: one convertible [with being a constituent], and two more general.[28]

Constituent parts

§147 There must be some dependence of certain parts upon others, but it cannot encompass them all in the same respect. §148 The parts may be distinguished externally or mentally. §149 When generality and its correlate [specificity] are considered as applying to them, they may be mutually exclusive or overlap. §150 They may be considered as materials, or as predicable [constituents]. §151 Genericity [الجنسية] and differentiality [الفصلية] then attach to them.

§152 The bringing into being of the two [genus [الجنس] and differentia] [الفصل] is one. §153 Here genus [الجنس] is like matter [المادة] and is an effect [المعلول]; the other [the differentia] [الفصل] is form [الصورة] and is a cause [العلة].[29] §154 What has no genus [الجنس] has no differentia [الفصل].

§155 There can be only one complete differentia [الفصل] [of a given quiddity] [الماهية].[30]

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humanity itself is. Unity and plurality, for example, are additional considerations rather than constituents of humanity as such. This is not an exception to the incompatibility of contradictories: the question concerns what belongs to the quiddity [الماهية] under the precise restriction "as such". Al-Ḥillī also cautions against inferring numerical identity from sameness of humanity. Saying that the humanity in Zayd and the humanity in 'Amr do not differ insofar as humanity does not establish one numerically identical entity, because numerical unity is itself an additional qualification. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 86.)

[27] §140. "Without any condition" does not mean "on condition that nothing accompany it". Al-Ḥillī considers the nature itself without making either the presence or the absence of further features a condition. Animality, for example, can therefore be present with the qualifications of a particular animal. His argument for its external existence [الوجود الخارجي] is that the qualified animal exists and its constitutive nature must accordingly exist in that individual. This does not posit a universal [الكلي] entity standing separately outside its instances. The following clause distinguishes three considerations: the nature itself is the natural universal [الكلي الطبيعي]; the universality attributed to it is the logical universal [الكلي المنطقي]; the nature together with universality is the intellectual universal [الكلي العقلي]. The latter two are mental, since what exists externally is individual. Consequently, affirmation of the natural universal outside thought and denial of externally existing universality are compatible within this explanation: the expressions pick out different considerations, not one claim simultaneously affirmed and denied. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 87.)

[28] §146. A constituent is prior to its composite in two directions: its presence is required for the composite to exist, and its absence suffices for that composite not to exist. Al-Ḥillī applies this dependence both to external realisation and to the mind's consideration of the composite. The resulting independence from a "further cause [السبب]" is carefully restricted. A part is not absolutely uncaused: the cause of the whole includes what causes its parts. Rather, no additional cause beyond that causal account is needed to make the constituent belong to the whole. Al-Ḥillī finally lists three properties: the constituent's priority [التقدم] in the relevant existences and nonexistences; its independence from a new cause; and its inseparability from that of which it is essential. Only the first is convertible with being a constituent. Some necessary concomitants also satisfy the latter two, so those features alone do not establish that something enters the quiddity [الماهية] as a part. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 90.)

[29] §153. The differentia [الفصل] is treated as causing the species' share of the genus [الجنس], not as producing the absolutely general genus as a separate existent.

[30] §155. The qualification "complete" matters. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes the whole essential differentiating constituent from an incomplete differentiating constituent that forms only part of it. The complete differentia [الفصل] cannot be multiple for the same quiddity [الماهية]: if

§156 A single quiddity [الماهية] cannot have two genera [الجنس] at the same rank. §157 There is no intellectual composition [التركيب] except from these two [genus [الجنس] and differentia] [الفصل]. §158 Their [series] must terminate. §159 Each can be intellectual, natural, or logical, just as their genera [الجنس] [the universal [الكلي] in each case] can. §160 Among each are highest, lowest, and intermediate [members].

§161 Some genera [الجنس] are isolated: they have no genus above them and none below them. The two [genus and differentia] [الفصل] are relational, and may coincide [in one thing under different respects] despite their opposition [التقابل].[31] §162 A genus [الجنس] cannot be taken as a genus in relation to its differentia [الفصل]. §163 Relative to [the species] to which they belong, the genus [الجنس] is broader and the differentia [الفصل] coextensive.

Individuation

§164 Individuation [التشخص] is a conceptual matter. Considered as an intellectual matter, it is found to share [the concept of individuation] with other individuations. No infinite regress [التسلسل] follows; [the series] ends when the consideration ends. §165 That by which individuation [التشخص] occurs may be the quiddity [الماهية] itself, in which case it admits no plurality [الكثرة]; or it may depend upon matter [المادة] individuated by the particular accidents [العرض] inhering in it. §166 Individuation [التشخص] does not arise by joining an intellectual universal [الكلي العقلي] to another such universal [الكلي]. §167 Distinction differs from individuation [التشخص]; each of two things may be distinguished by the other.

§168 An individual's sharing [a character with others] may be left out of consideration; a universal [الكلي] may be a relative [particular] and so be distinguished; and an individual falling under a general concept is distinguished.[32]

Unity and plurality

§169 Individuation [التشخص] differs from unity [الوحدة]. §170 Unity [الوحدة] differs from existence [الوجود], since existence is true of the many as many whereas unity is not; yet unity is coextensive with existence.[33]

The indefinability of unity

§171 Unity [الوحدة] can be defined only by explaining the expression. §172 Unity [الوحدة] and plurality [الكثرة] are on a par with respect to intellect [العقل] and imagination [الخيال]: each has its own share in being better known [unity to intellect, plurality to imagination].

The conceptual character of unity

§173 Unity [الوحدة] is not an external entity; it belongs to the second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية]. The same holds for plurality [الكثرة].

The opposition of unity and plurality

§174 Their opposition [التقابل] arises from the relations [الإضافة] of cause [العلة] and effect [المعلول], and measure and measured, rather than from an opposition between their essences [الذات].

Kinds of unity

§175 The subject [المعروض] of the two may be one; it must then have two respects. If the respect of unity [الوحدة] neither constitutes the respect of plurality [الكثرة] nor attaches to it, the unity is accidental. If it attaches to it, [the unity concerns] a subject, or predicates attaching to one subject, or the reverse [subjects sharing one predicate]. If it constitutes it, the unity is generic, specific, or differential. Their subjects may instead differ. A subject consisting solely in indivisibility is unity without qualification. Otherwise, if it has an additional concept and spatial position [الوضع], it is a point; if it has no spatial

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either of two purported complete differentiae already sufficed to distinguish the composite, the other would be unnecessary for that differentiation. His second argument invokes the differentia's causal role in determining the relevant share of the genus [الجنس]; two complete differentiae would duplicate the cause of that same determination. Incomplete differentiae, by contrast, can be several because they constitute parts of the complete differentiating account. The sentence therefore concerns uniqueness for a given quiddity, not one differentia shared by every species, and it does not assert that every quiddity must possess a differentia. The bracketed phrase makes that local scope explicit. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 94.)

[31] §161. The opposition [التقابل] is between logical roles. A single feature can be a genus [الجنس] relative to one item and a differentia [الفصل] relative to another.

[32] §168. Al-Ḥillī uses three cases to show that distinction and individuation [التشخص] overlap without being identical. First, one can consider an individual without considering what it shares with others. The individual remains individuated even though comparison and differentiation are not being considered; this does not deny that it actually shares features with other things. Second, a universal [الكلي] can be distinguished from another universal while remaining universal. It is a "relative particular" when subordinated to a more general universal, not a numerically individual object. Third, when an individual is considered as falling under a general concept, both individuation and distinction apply. The passage therefore concerns different conceptual relations and their scopes. Merely distinguishing one kind from another does not individuate an instance of that kind, while individuating a thing does not require every comparison with other things to be made explicit in thought. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 98.)

[33] §170. The text distinguishes the concepts of unity [الوحدة] and existence [الوجود] while maintaining their coextension. It is not saying that a plurality fails to exist.

position, it is immaterial. This applies if it admits no division. If it does, it is a magnitude, a simple body [الجسم], or a composite body.[34]

§176 Some of these have a stronger claim to unity [الوحدة] than others. §177 Identity ['it is it'] follows the same pattern. §178 The names for unity [الوحدة] in an accidental or essential attribute vary according to what unity is related to. §179 Two [distinct things] becoming one is impossible. Identity therefore requires respects of difference and unity, as already explained.[35] §180 Unity [الوحدة] is the principle of number, which is constituted by unity alone.

§181 When another like it is added, twoness results, and this is a species of number. Further species with different realities [الحقيقة] then arise without limit by adding one at a time: these are the species of number. §182 Each is a conceptual matter that the intellect [العقل] predicates of realities [الحقيقة] when it joins them together intellectually in the relevant manner. §183 Unity [الوحدة] may attach to itself and to its opposite [plurality] [الكثرة], and [the iteration] ends when the consideration ends.

§184 It may share a common character [with other unities], and is then specified by the commonly named correlate. The same holds for its opposite.[36]

§185 It is related to its subject [الموضوع] in two respects, and to its opposite in a third. The same holds for its opposite.[37]

Kinds of opposition

§186 To that opposite [plurality] [الكثرة] there attaches what cannot attach to unity: opposition [التقابل]. §187 Opposition [التقابل] divides into four kinds: negation and affirmation, concerning assertion and belief [الاعتقاد]; privation [عدم الملكة] and possession [الملكة], which is the first [kind] taken with a certain restriction; the opposition of contraries [الضد], both of which are positive, and whose precise and common usages stand in the reverse relation [النسبة] to those of the preceding kind; and correlative opposition [تقابل التضايف].[38] §188 The genus [الجنس] [opposition [التقابل] itself] falls under this [last kind] by virtue of an accompanying consideration.[39] §189 It is predicated analogically [التشكيك] of the four, and the third [contrariety] [التضاد] is the strongest in opposition [التقابل]. §190 The first is called contradiction [التناقض]; it is realised in propositions under eight conditions.

§191 This applies to singular propositions [القضايا الشخصية]. In quantified propositions [القضايا المحصورة] a ninth condition is required: difference in quantification. For two universals are contrary [الضد], while the two particulars may both be true. §192 In modal propositions

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[34] §175. The first branch concerns one bearer considered as both one and many under different respects. Al-Ḥillī then distinguishes accidental agreement from unity [الوحدة] grounded in a common subject [الموضوع], a shared predicate, or an essential constituent. His examples clarify the otherwise compressed grammar. A writer and a laugher can be one through the human subject bearing both predicates; cotton and snow can agree through whiteness. Agreement between the ruler's relation to a city and the captain's relation to a ship is only accidental unity between distinct relations. Essential unity is instead generic, specific, or differential. The later branches classify the bearer of unity itself. Bare indivisibility gives unity without qualification. Where there is an additional concept, an indivisible bearer with spatial position [الوضع] is a point; without spatial position, the examples are intellect [العقل] and soul [النفس]. Divisible bearers are then distinguished as magnitude, simple body [الجسم], or composite body. These are alternative classificatory branches, not successive assertions that one object has all these characters. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 102.)

[35] §179. The rejected union concerns two numerically distinct things becoming one numerically identical thing. Predicative identity remains possible through difference in conception [التصور] and unity in what is referred to.

[36] §184. Al-Ḥillī offers two readings and prefers the first. On that reading, Zayd's unity and 'Amr's unity share the concept of being one but are distinguished through the subjects to which they belong. The "commonly named correlate" is the concrete bearer, such as Zayd, whereas the strict relation is his unity. The same applies to plurality: ten humans and ten horses share tenfoldness while their bearers distinguish them. His alternative reading begins from the common character of bare indivisibility. Since that character is shared, it is not itself a genuinely individual one; the distinct concrete bearer has a better claim to that description. The translation follows the first interpretation and retains the technical expression that makes it possible. It should not be taken as if Ṭūsī had supplied this entire explanation unambiguously: the alternatives and the commentator's preference are part of the evidence. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 106.)

[37] §185. Al-Ḥillī introduces his explanation as the closest interpretation he can give of the wording. Unity is related to its bearer first as that bearer's unity: it is the unity of this one thing. It is related to the same bearer again through inherence, as an accident [العرض] subsisting in a subject [الموضوع]. Its third relation is to plurality as its opposite. Al-Ḥillī gives the same threefold pattern for plurality. The distinction is between respects of relation, not an assertion that the subject contains two separately described unities. Nor should the first two relations be collapsed merely because their bearer is the same. The compressed lemma does not itself name these relations individually; their identification comes from the commentator's explicitly qualified explanation. That qualification remains important when reading this passage alongside the alternative interpretations offered immediately before it. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 107.)

[38] §187. The comparative claim concerns the breadth of common and precise usages. In the account explained by al-Ḥillī, strict contrariety is narrower than common contrariety, while the relation [النسبة] is reversed for privation [عدم الملكة] and possession [الملكة].

[39] §188. Opposition [التقابل] considered precisely as a relation to an opposite is correlative, even though the underlying opposed things need not themselves be correlatives. The genus [الجنس] consequently falls under a species only under that added consideration.

[القضايا الموجهة] a tenth [condition is required]: the modalities must differ so that the two cannot both be true or both be false.

§193 When nonexistence [العدم] is qualified by possession [الملكة] in propositions, they are called propositions with privative predicates [القضايا المعدولة] (maʿdūla). They oppose the corresponding positive propositions in truth, but not in falsity: the subject [الموضوع] may not exist, in which case the contradictories of both are true.[40]

§194 A subject [الموضوع] may necessarily have one determinate contrary [الضد], or one without determination; or it may require neither, being free of both or possessing an intermediate. §195 One thing cannot have two contraries [الضد] [in the same respect].[41] §196 Contrariety [التضاد] does not apply to genera [الجنس]. §197 Contrariety [التضاد] between species requires that they belong to the same [proximate] genus [الجنس].[42]

§198 The bringing into being of genus [الجنس] and differentia [الفصل] is one.[43]

Chapter 3 · Cause and effect

§199 Everything from which something proceeds, whether independently or together with something else, is a cause [العلة] of it; what proceeds is its effect [المعلول].

The four causes

§200 Causes are efficient [الفاعلية], material [المادية], formal [الصورية], and final [الغائية].

The efficient cause

§201 The efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية] is the principle of producing an effect [المعلول]. When it exists with every respect required for its efficacy, the effect must exist. §202 Nor must [causal efficacy] [التأثير] be accompanied by [the effect [المعلول]'s prior] nonexistence [العدم].[44] §203 The effect [المعلول] cannot persist after [the efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية] ceases], though this is possible in the case of a preparatory cause [العلة المعدة]. §204 When the cause [العلة] is one, the effect [المعلول] is one.[45] §205 Multiplicity [الكثرة] then arises through a multiplicity of relations [الإضافة].

§206 This judgment is convertible. §207 In the case of specific unity [الوحدة], it is not convertible.[46] §208 The two relations [النسبة] [causality [العلية] and being an effect] [المعلول] are second intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية], and are opposed correlatively. §209 They may coincide in one thing in relation [النسبة] to two different matters, but the roles cannot be reversed in those same matters.

Arguments against infinite regress

§210 Their subjects [المعروض] cannot ascend without end in a single series: no member can occur without a necessary cause [العلة], yet what is necessary through another cannot [occur without a cause] either. There must therefore be an intrinsically [necessary] cause that is an endpoint.[47]

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[40] §193. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes an affirmative proposition whose predicate includes a negation from the negation of an entire affirmative proposition. His example is the equivalent of "Zayd is a non-writer": the negative element belongs after the connection between subject [الموضوع] and predicate. This differs from simply saying that Zayd is not a writer. The affirmative positive and affirmative privative propositions cannot both be true of the same subject, at the same time, in the same respect. Under the account given here, however, both can be false if the subject does not exist. Their respective contradictory negatives can then both be true. Thus "oppose in truth, but not in falsity" concerns the impossibility of joint truth together with the possibility [الإمكان] of joint falsity. The argument relies on the existential requirements assigned to these affirmative predications; it should not be read as treating the privative predicate as the contradictory negation of the whole positive sentence. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 111.)

[41] §195. Al-Ḥillī restricts the claim to a single respect of opposition. Opposition under two different respects gives two different oppositions and lies outside the present claim.

[42] §197. The qualification "proximate" follows al-Ḥillī's specification of "one lowest genus [الجنس]" (jins wahid akhir).

[43] §198. This repeats the earlier proposition about genus [الجنس] and differentia [الفصل], now within the account of contrariety. Al-Ḥillī suggests that it answers an objection to requiring contrary species to fall under one genus. Their common genus cannot itself distinguish the contraries, so one might locate the contrariety in their differentiae instead; but those differentiae need not share a further genus. His proposed answer is that genus and differentia are distinguishable in thought but form one externally realised nature. There is no independently existing animality to which rationality is subsequently attached to form a human. Contrariety therefore belongs externally to the species, rather than to separately realised differentiae. Al-Ḥillī explicitly calls this what he understands from the passage and allows that someone else may understand it differently. The note reports his proposed rationale; it does not convert that rationale into an unquestionable expansion of Ṭūsī's words or delete the repeated proposition as redundant. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 112.)

[44] §202. Al-Ḥillī explains that prior nonexistence [العدم] is required for an act of a willing agent [الفاعل المختار], but is not a necessary condition of causation as such, since a necessitating cause can be considered otherwise.

[45] §204. Al-Ḥillī restricts the disputed one-from-one argument to a necessitating cause [العلة] considered in one respect, and criticises a proof offered for it. The matn's concise assertion is retained; the commentator's criticism is not presented as part of Ṭūsī's wording.

[46] §207. A cause one in species produces an effect one in species, but the same species of effect can have causes different in species. Al-Ḥillī uses heat from motion [الحركة], the sun, and fire.

[47] §210. The subjects [المعروض] in question are bearers of the relations of cause [العلة] and effect. Al-Ḥillī presents this as the first argument against their continuing without an endpoint in one infinite causal series. Each member is intrinsically possible and cannot exist without a cause that makes its existence [الوجود] necessary. If that cause is itself

§211 Also because of the one-to-one correspondence [التطبيق] between a totality from which finitely many members have been removed and another from which none have been removed.[48] §212 Also because applying one-to-one correspondence [التطبيق] with respect to the two relations [النسبة], so that each member is counted under both, entails that the two [series] terminate: one relation must exceed the other because of its priority [السبق]. §213 Also, if what produces the totality were one of its parts, a thing would produce itself and its causes [العلة]. The totality has a complete cause [العلة التامة], whereas no part is a complete cause, since the whole is not necessitated by that part. How could the whole be necessitated by something that itself depends on infinitely many members of that whole?

Cause and effect in existence and nonexistence

§214 The two relations [النسبة] correspond on both sides of the contradictory [existence [الوجود] and nonexistence] [العدم].

Reception and agency

§215 Reception [القبول] and agency are incompatible when the relation [النسبة] is the same, because their concomitants are incompatible.[49]

The relation between cause and effect

§216 The cause [العلة] and effect [المعلول] must differ in nature if the effect intrinsically needs that cause; otherwise this is not required.

Accompaniment and causality

§217 Neither relation [النسبة] is necessarily true of what accompanies [its bearer].

Causality among elemental individuals

§218 No individual elemental thing is the essential cause [العلة] of another such individual; otherwise the individuals would be infinite. Also because it can dispense with that [particular individual] through another; §219 because [the alleged cause] [العلة] has no priority [التقدم]; §220 because the two are on a par; §221 and because either may persist when its companion has ceased to exist.

The production of human acts

§222 An agent among us requires a particular conception [التصور] to specify the action, then desire, then will [الإرادة], then movement of the muscles, so that the action arises from us.

§223 Movement to a place follows a will [الإرادة] appropriate to it. The particular stages of that movement follow particular imaginings and volitions. Earlier instances of these imaginings and volitions cause earlier stages of movement, which prepare for further [volitions]. Thus volitions in the soul [النفس] and movements along the distance continue to their respective ends.[50]

Spatial situation and bodily causation

§224 Spatial situation [الوضع] is required for efficacy to belong to what accompanies matter [المادة].

The finitude of bodily capacities

§225 So is finitude with respect to duration, number, and intensity, in terms of which finitude and its proper privation [عدم الملكة] are predicated of what produces the effect.[51]

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necessary only through another, it remains intrinsically possible and shares the same dependence. The argument concludes that the series requires a cause necessary through itself. "Necessary cause" must therefore be read with attention to the subsequent distinction: the cause initially invoked need not yet have been shown intrinsically necessary. Al-Ḥillī nevertheless ends this exposition by stating that he has a reservation about the argument. He does not develop that reservation here. His faithful presentation of the intended reasoning should consequently not be mistaken for an unqualified endorsement of this particular proof. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 117.)

[48] §211. The one-to-one correspondence [التطبيق] (taṭbīq) arguments are translated as historical arguments against an infinite causal series. They are not silently reformulated in terms of modern set theory.

[49] §215. Reception [القبول] is considered in respect of a subject's lack of intrinsic sufficiency for the received feature; agency in respect of supplying what suffices. The qualification 'when the relation [النسبة] is the same' prevents a blanket denial that one thing can act in one respect and receive in another.

[50] §223. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes the overall intention to complete a movement from the particular imaginings and volitions [الإرادة] associated with successive stages along its divisible distance. A volition for the first stage produces that movement. Reaching that stage, together with the continuing overall intention, then brings about a further volition directed toward the next stage. That volition produces another movement, and the sequence continues. Hence a movement can help cause a volition while a volition causes a movement without circular causation: the movements and volitions involved are different successive particulars. This explanation supplies the antecedent of the lemma's final elliptical reference to "another", rendered [volitions]. The preparatory role of the earlier movement is essential; the passage does not say that a completed movement simply generates all subsequent movements by itself or that one unchanged particular volition accounts for every stage. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 124.)

[51] §225. This clause first specifies how finitude can be attributed to a bodily capacity [القوة الجسمانية]. Al-Ḥillī says finitude and its corresponding privation [عدم الملكة] belong directly to quantity; they are attributed to capacities through the measured effects those capacities produce. He distinguishes three measures. Intensity compares the times needed for the same work, such as arrows crossing a fixed distance: the shorter time represents greater intensity. Duration compares how long

§226 For forced [motion] [الحركة] varies with the recipient; when the starting point is the same, the opposite endpoint differs.[52] §227 Natural [motion] [الحركة] varies with the agent, since the small and large are equal in receptivity [القبول]. Thus, when the two move from the same starting point, finitude follows.

The material cause

§228 The substrate [المحل] constituted by what inheres in it is its recipient and the matter [المادة] of the composite. §229 Its receptivity [القبول] is intrinsic. §230 Nearness and remoteness [to receiving a form] [الصورة] may arise through dispositions [الاستعداد] acquired by virtue of what inheres in it.

The formal cause

§231 What thus inheres is the form [الصورة] of the composite and a partial efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية] of its substrate [المحل]. §232 It is one.

The final cause

§233 The end, through its quiddity [الماهية], causes the efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية]'s causality [العلية]; in its existence [الوجود] it is caused by the effect [المعلول]. §234 It belongs to every purposive agent. §235 The end of the animal motive faculty is to reach the terminus. This may or may not also be the end of the appetitive faculty. If [the latter end] is not attained, the movement is futile. Otherwise it is good, habitual, necessarily intended, or playful and aimless. §236 They affirm ends for natural events, and likewise for chance events.

Divisions of causes

§237 A cause [العلة], generally considered, may be simple or composite; §238 in potentiality [القوة] or in actuality [الفعل]; §239 universal [الكلي] or particular; §240 per se [بالذات] or per accidens [بالعرض]; §241 generic or specific;

§242 proximate or remote; §243 shared or peculiar. §244 The prior nonexistence [العدم] of an originated thing [الحادث] is among its accidental principles. §245 The efficient cause [العلة الفاعلية] on the two sides [existence [الوجود] and nonexistence] [العدم] is one. §246 The subject [الموضوع] is like matter [المادة] [in its causal role].

The effect and its dependence

§247 The effect [الأثر]'s dependence is only with respect to one of its two sides [existence [الوجود] and nonexistence] [العدم].[53] §248 The causes of quiddity [الماهية] differ from the causes of existence [الوجود]. §249 Nonexistence [العدم] must have a cause [السبب]; the same applies to [the cessation of] motion [الحركة].[54] §250 Among preparatory causes [العلة المعدة] are those that lead to a like, to something different, or to a contrary [الضد]. §251 Preparation may be proximate or remote.

§252 Some accidental causes are preparatory.

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an effect continues. Number compares how many successive acts a capacity produces. These measures must not be exchanged without argument, since greater intensity is not simply longer duration or more repeated acts. The "proper privation" is nonfinitude in something of a kind capable of finitude, not every unqualified negative use of "not finite". The following clauses attempt to establish the finitude of bodily capacities; this clause provides the distinctions on which those physical arguments depend. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 125.)

[52] §226. The condensed physical argument compares motions [الحركة] from the same starting point, with differing recipients or motive forces [القوة]. Al-Ḥillī discusses objections to the argument; those objections are not part of the matn.

[53] §247. The claim concerns making an effect [الأثر] existent or nonexistent, rather than making its essential nature what it is. Read alongside §127, where producing quiddity [الماهية] concerns its actualisation rather than altering its definition.

[54] §249. Al-Ḥillī addresses the objection that nonpersistent things, such as motions [الحركة] and sounds, cease through themselves. He instead connects their cessation to the absence of their cause [السبب] or of a condition.

Division 2
Substances and accidents

This division comprises chapters.

Chapter 1 · Substances

§253 A contingent existent [الممكن] either exists in a subject [الموضوع], in which case it is an accident [العرض], or does not, in which case it is a substance [الجوهر].[55] §254 A substance [الجوهر] is either separate [from matter] [المادة] in its essence [الذات] and action, in which case it is an intellect [العقل]; separate in its essence [but not its action], in which case it is a soul [النفس]; or conjoined [with matter]. In the last case, it is either a receptacle [المحل], namely matter; something inhering, namely form [الصورة]; or a composite of the two, namely body [الجسم]. §255 Subject [الموضوع] and receptacle [المحل] reverse their relations [النسبة] of generality and specificity when existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] are considered. The same holds for what inheres and accident [العرض]. §256 Subject [الموضوع] and accident [العرض] are mutually exclusive.

§257 "Accident [العرض]" is predicated of some receptacles [المحل] and some things that inhere. §258 Substantiality [الجوهرية] and accidentality [العرضية] are secondary intelligibles [المعقولات الثانية], because attributing either of them [to a thing] depends on a middle term [in a proof]. §259 [This is also shown by] the differing priority [الأولوية] of the species [in possessing these descriptions]. §260 What is understood as common [to them] is accidental. §261 There is no contrariety [التضاد] among substances [الجوهر], nor between substances and anything else.

§262 What is understood by annihilation is nonexistence [العدم]. §263 Contrariety [التضاد] may, however, be applied to some [substances] [الجوهر] in another respect. §264 The unity [الوحدة] of the receptacle [المحل] does not entail the unity of what inheres in it, except when [the inhering things] are alike. The converse, however, does hold. §265 As for division, neither side entails [division of] the other. §266 The subject [الموضوع] is among the individuating factors [of an accident] [العرض].

§267 What inheres may require an intermediate receptacle [المحل].

[55] §253. "Subject [الموضوع]" (mawḍūʿ) is a self-subsistent support for an accident [العرض]; "receptacle [المحل]" (maḥall) is broader and can include prime matter [الهيولى] as the receptacle of substantial form. The distinctions in §§255–257 depend on keeping these terms separate.

Atoms and the divisibility of body

§268 Nothing that has spatial position [الوضع] and is indivisible exists independently.[56]

§269 For an intervening [atom] [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ] blocks [the two outer atoms from touching].[57]

§270 And because of the movement of the two [atoms] [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ] placed at the ends of a [line] composed of three [atoms]. §271 Or of four, with the two [moving atoms] [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ] exchanging positions. §272 Their position entails what sense perception [الحس] attests to be false: disintegration, the rest [السكون] of what is moving, and the nonexistence [العدم] of the circle. §273 A point is an accident [العرض] inhering in what is divisible, in respect of its termination. §274 Motion [الحركة] does not exist in the present [instant]; it does not follow that motion does not exist at all.

§275 The instant has no actuality outside the mind. §276 Were motion [الحركة] composed of indivisibles, it would not exist. §277 Besides the preceding objections, the proponent of infinitely many [actual] parts is refuted by the existence [الوجود] of a composite made from finitely many parts; generalizing [this refutation to all bodies] [الجسم] requires proportionality. §278 It also entails that the faster [body] [الجسم] cannot overtake the slower. §279 And that a finite distance cannot be traversed in a finite time.

§280 Self-evident judgment [الضرورة] rules out both leaping [الطفرة] [over intervening positions] and interpenetration [التداخل]. §281 Division in its several forms produces a duality in which the nature of each [part] is the same as the nature of the whole. §282 Impossibility [الامتناع] of separation due to an incidental factor does not entail intrinsic impossibility [الامتناع الذاتي]. §283 It has thus been

[56] §268. The denial concerns an independently existing spatial indivisible: the atom [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ]. It does not deny a point existing as a boundary of something divisible (§273). The brief geometrical objections that follow are not complete standalone proofs; Ḥillī expands their constructions.

[57] §269. Al-Ḥillī expands this into an argument against an indivisible atom [الجزء الذي لا يتجزأ] occupying a spatial position. Suppose one atom lies between two others. Either it prevents the outer two from touching, or it does not. If it does not, the bodies interpenetrate, an outcome the argument excludes. If it does, the side of the middle atom touching one neighbour must differ from the side touching the other; that difference establishes divisibility. The conclusion follows from the distinction between the two contacts, together with the exclusion of interpenetration. "Blocks" therefore describes the middle atom's preventing contact between the outer pair. It is not a claim that the middle atom prevents either neighbour from touching it. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 144.)

established that body [الجسم] is one continuous thing, capable of division without limit.

§284 This does not entail the existence [الوجود] of matter [المادة] other than body [الجسم], because an infinite regress [التسلسل] and the existence of infinitely many [actual things] are impossible.[58]

Natural place and shape

§285 Every body [الجسم] has a natural place [المكان الطبيعي], which it seeks by the shortest route when displaced from it. §286 Were [its natural place] [المكان الطبيعي] multiple, it would cease to be [natural]. §287 The place of a composite is the place of its predominant [element], or the place in which it happens to exist. §288 The same applies to shape; the natural shape is the sphere. §289 What is understood by the former [that is, place] is dimension; the indications support this.

§290 Know that dimension is of two kinds: one is conjoined with matter [المادة], inheres in body [الجسم], and excludes an equal [material dimension from interpenetrating it]; the other is separate, with bodies occupying it. It meets them in their entirety and interpenetrates them, coinciding with and uniting with the dimension of what occupies it. There is no impossibility [الامتناع] in its being free of matter.[59]

§291 If place were a surface, the judgments [about motion [الحركة] and rest] [السكون] would be contradictory. §292 Nor would place extend to every [body] [الجسم].

§293 This place cannot be unoccupied. Otherwise motion [الحركة] with an impediment would equal motion without one, when a lesser impediment is assumed in the ratio of their two times.[60]

Direction

§294 Direction is the extremity of the extension established along the line of pointing. §295 It is not divisible. §296 It has position and is the object both of movement aimed at reaching it and of pointing. §297 The natural directions are above and below; the others are unlimited.

Chapter 2 · Bodies

§298 They are of two kinds, celestial and elemental. Of the celestial bodies [الجسم], the comprehensive spheres are nine: an unstarred sphere encompassing all, beneath it the sphere of the fixed stars, then the spheres of the seven wandering stars. These include epicycles and eccentric spheres, twenty-four in all. They contain seven wandering stars and a thousand and twenty-odd fixed stars. §299 They are all simple. §300 [They are] free of active and passive qualities [الكيفية] and what follows from those qualities. §301 [They are] transparent. §302 There are four simple elements, all spherical: fire, air, water, and earth. Their number is derived from the pairings of active and passive qualities [الكيفية].

§303 Each changes into its adjacent [element], and into a nonadjacent one through one or more intermediaries. §304 Fire is hot, dry, and transparent. It moves in dependence [on the sphere], has a single layer, and has the capacity [القوة] to transform a composite into itself. §305 Air is hot, moist, and transparent, and has four layers. §306 Water is cold, moist, and transparent. It surrounds three quarters of the earth and has one layer. §307 Earth is

[58] §284. Al-Ḥillī presents the argument for matter [المادة] distinct from body [الجسم] as Avicenna's: body is continuous but can be divided; continuity itself cannot receive its own negation, so a substrate [المحل] must receive both continuity and separation. Ṭūsī challenges the inference to this substrate. Before division the continuous body is supposed to have one matter; after division each part has its own. If the matter of each part newly arises, the principle that everything newly arising requires matter generates a regress. If those matters already existed, the body's unlimited possible divisions require infinitely many actual matters. Al-Ḥillī identifies this as Ṭūsī's objection to inferring matter distinct from body merely from divisibility. The preceding conclusion that body is continuous and divisible without limit therefore does not commit the author to Avicenna's analysis of body into matter and form. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 150.)

[59] §290. The objection answered here is that, if place is dimension, placing a body [الجسم] in it would bring two dimensions together in the same extent. Al-Ḥillī explains the reply by distinguishing dimension conjoined with matter [المادة] from dimension free of matter. Two material dimensions exclude one another: two bodies cannot interpenetrate. The dimension that constitutes place, however, can coincide with the material dimension of its occupant without the prohibited interpenetration [التداخل] of two material bodies. Its freedom from matter is part of the proposed account of what place is. Whether place can actually lack an occupant is a further question, answered negatively at §293. The present statement should therefore retain its claim about matter-free dimension; it should not be reduced to the claim that dimension is separable from matter only in thought. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 152, 154.)

[60] §293. Al-Ḥillī illustrates the reductio by stipulating that a body traverses an empty distance in one hour and the same distance filled with a resisting medium in two. Now suppose a second medium with half the first medium's resistance. On the proportional assumption used in the argument, the body will traverse it in one hour. Motion [الحركة] through a resisting medium would then take exactly as long as motion without resistance, which the argument treats as impossible. The conclusion is that place cannot be empty. The durations are hypothetical premises used to expose a contradiction; the passage does not assert that motion through an actual void has a known duration. Its crucial dependency is the assumed relation between a reduction of resistance and a reduction of traversal time. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 154.)

cold and dry, stationary at the center, transparent, and has three layers.

§308 As for composites, these four are their elements. §309 Composites originate when some [elements] act upon others.

§310 A quality [الكيفية] acts upon matter [المادة] and diminishes the purity of the quality it bears. The result is an intermediate quality, uniform throughout the whole: temperament [المزاج].[61]

§311 [This occurs] while the forms [الصورة] of the simple [elements] are preserved.

§312 Temperaments [المزاج] then differ in their preparation [of composites to receive forms] [الصورة], according to their proximity to, or distance from, equilibrium.[62]

§313 Although individual temperaments [المزاج] are unlimited, each species has two extremes, of excess and deficiency. They [the principal temperaments] are nine.

Chapter 3 · Further judgments concerning bodies

§314 All bodies [الجسم] must be finite. For what is assumed to be infinite must be finite when compared with an equal [magnitude], on the assumption that it is smaller than that magnitude.[63]

§315 And because the ratio between the two sides of an angle and what they enclose is preserved, while the latter must be finite. §316 The unity [الوحدة] of the definition and the absence of division within it indicate unity [of bodily nature]. §317 Self-evident judgment [الضرورة] affirms their persistence. §318 Bodies [الجسم] may be devoid of qualities [الكيفية] that are tasted, seen, or smelled, as air is. §319 They can be seen provided that light and color are present; this is self-evident.

§320 All bodies [الجسم] have originated in time, since they are inseparable from finitely many originated particulars. For they are never without motion [الحركة] or rest [السكون], and each of these originates, as is evident. §321 Their particulars are finite because the existence [الوجود] of infinitely many [things] is impossible, by the argument from correspondence [التطبيق]; also because every originated event [الحادث] is described by the two opposed relations [الإضافة] [of preceding and following]. What is described by one, insofar as it is so described, must exceed what is described by the other. Thus the lesser series terminates, and the greater does too. §322 Self-evident judgment [الضرورة] affirms the origination [الحدوث] of whatever is inseparable from finitely many originated events [الحادث].

§323 Bodies [الجسم], therefore, originate; and since [corporeal] accidents [العرض] cannot subsist except in bodies, their origination [الحدوث] is established as well.[64]

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[61] §310. Al-Ḥillī explains the problem as one of reciprocal action: how can each of two opposed qualities [الكيفية] both overcome and be overcome by the other? The account adopted by Ṭūsī distinguishes the active quality from the matter [المادة] that receives its action. For example, the heat of hot water acts upon the matter of cold water, weakening the coldness that qualifies it. Their mixture acquires a uniform quality intermediate between heat and cold; this is temperament [المزاج]. Al-Ḥillī identifies this as Ṭūsī's chosen account but then questions it. In his view, the proposed distinction does not yet settle how matter's being affected avoids the original difficulty concerning simultaneous dominance and submission. The note accordingly distinguishes the explanation of the author's position from the commentator's reservation about its adequacy. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 164.)

[62] §312. Al-Ḥillī explains temperament [المزاج] as preparing a composite to receive its characteristic form [الصورة] and capacities [القوة]. All composites share corporeality, but their capacities differ. A mineral form holds its constituents together; a plant additionally nourishes itself, grows, and reproduces; an animal additionally senses and moves voluntarily. The difference is traced to the receptacles [المحل]' differing preparation, which in turn depends on differences of temperament. A temperament nearer equilibrium receives a more perfect soul [النفس]. The electronic transcription reads al-aʿdād, "numbers," but this explanation requires al-iʿdād, "preparation." The reading al-iʿdād is also confirmed in al-Jalālī's edition, p.152; the displayed Arabic corrects the transcription accordingly. "Preparation" thus concerns a composite's readiness to receive form and capacities, not a numerical ordering of temperaments. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 165.)

[63] §314. Al-Ḥillī calls this the argument by correspondence. Assume two infinite lines beginning at the same point. Remove a finite segment from one, then match the beginning of the remainder to the beginning of the complete line and continue matching their parts. If both continue indefinitely, the diminished line equals the undiminished one, which the argument rejects. If the diminished line ends, the complete line must also end, since it exceeds the first by only the finite segment removed. The conclusion contradicts the assumed infinity of the lines. Al-Ḥillī explicitly identifies the "contrary" of finitude as the infinity initially assumed, the comparison as matching parts, and the deficiency as the removed segment. This supplies the stages compressed into Ṭūsī's single sentence. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 166–167.)

[64] §323. The conclusion about accidents [العرض] has a restricted scope here. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes corporeal accidents from noncorporeal accidents and says that this particular inference concerns the former. A corporeal accident cannot subsist by itself or in something other than a body [الجسم]. Since the body on which its existence [الوجود] depends originates, the accident dependent on it also originates. Al-Ḥillī regards noncorporeal accidents as originated too, but assigns that claim to a different argument establishing the origination [الحدوث] of everything other than God. The supplied "[corporeal]" therefore marks the restriction he expressly attributes to Ṭūsī's reasoning. It prevents the present dependence argument from appearing to deny that there are accidents whose subjects are noncorporeal. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 173.)

§324 Origination [الحدوث] occurs at its particular [first] time because no time precedes it. According to some, a voluntary agent [الفاعل المختار] gives preference to one of two alternatives within its power [القدرة] without a [further determining] factor. §325 [The requirement of preexistent] matter [المادة] is denied. §326 Priority [القبلية] does not require time; this has already been established.

Chapter 4 · Immaterial substances

§327 As for intellect [العقل], no proof of its impossibility [الامتناع] has been established. §328 The proofs of its existence [الوجود] are defective: for example, their claim that two things cannot proceed from the One; that what is conditioned, in its action or its existence, by something posterior cannot have priority [السبق]; and that neither can what lacks the capacity to act as a cause [العلة]. [These arguments fail] because the cause here acts voluntarily.

§329 So too their claim that circular motion [الحركة] requires will [الإرادة], which requires assimilation to what is perfect: seeking what is already actual, or what is potential [and attainable all at once], would bring the motion to an end, while seeking the impossible is impossible. [This argument fails] because it depends on the uninterrupted continuity of what we have shown to be temporally bounded [at its beginning], and on an exhaustive division of the kinds of seeking; moreover, the impossibility [الامتناع] of seeking the impossible is disputed.[65]

§330 So too their claim that neither of the correlatives [the encompassing and the encompassed] can cause the other, lest the impossible become possible, or the stronger be caused by the weaker. [This fails] because impossibility in itself [الامتناع الذاتي] [of a void] is denied.

The soul and its immateriality

§331 The soul [النفس] is the first perfection [الكمال الأول] of a natural, organic body [الجسم] possessing life potentially.[66]

§332 It differs from that for which it is a condition [namely, temperament] [المزاج], because circularity [الدور] is impossible. §333 And because [soul [النفس] and temperament] [المزاج] oppose one another in what they require. §334 And because one can cease while the other persists. §335 It also differs from that of which one can be unaware [namely, the body] [البدن]. §336 And from that through which [one] shares [a nature with other bodies] [الجسم].

§337 And from that in which replacement occurs. §338 It is an immaterial substance [الجوهر المجرد], because its accident [العرض] [knowledge] [العلم] is immaterial. §339 And because that accident [العرض] is indivisible. §340 And because the soul [النفس] has the capacity [القوة] to do what things conjoined with matter [المادة] cannot.

§341 And because its accident [العرض] [of intellection] [التعقل] has its supposed receptacle [المحل] [the heart or brain] as an object only intermittently.[67]

§342 And because the independence of the accident [العرض] entails the independence of its bearer. §343 And because [the soul [النفس]'s intellectual faculty] [القوة] does not follow [the body [البدن]'s weakening]. §344 And because the

[65] §329. The opening presents a philosophers' proof for separate intellects [العقل]. Circular celestial motion [الحركة] is said to require will [الإرادة]; voluntary motion requires a goal; and unending motion must seek a perfection attained successively rather than all at once. The celestial sphere is accordingly said to seek likeness to an intellect whose perfections are actual, realizing its own possible positions in succession. Ṭūsī's objections begin with the dependence of this proof on uninterrupted motion, continue with the disputed exhaustiveness of its classification of goals, and question whether an agent can seek something impossible. Al-Ḥillī explains that ignorance of a goal's impossibility [الامتناع] can sustain such seeking. He explicitly relates the temporal objection to the preceding proof that the world originated. The limit on motion therefore concerns its beginning; this clause does not establish that celestial motion must cease at some future time. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 178.)

[66] §331. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes a first perfection [الكمال الأول], through which a thing belongs to its species, from a second perfection [الكمال الثاني], a property or activity that it has once constituted as that species. Soul [النفس] is a first perfection in this sense. "Natural" excludes artifacts such as a bed; "organic" means furnished with organs or instruments for vital activities. Those activities include nutrition, growth, reproduction, perception, voluntary movement, and reasoning. He also explains the choice of "perfection" rather than "form [الصورة]": when body [الجسم] is considered as matter [المادة], the soul's association with it can be described in terms of form; when body is considered as a genus [الجنس] awaiting further specification, soul is its perfection. The wording accommodates the human soul, which the account holds to perfect the body without inhering in it. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 181.)

[67] §341. The alleged receptacle [المحل] is the heart or brain, considered as something the soul [النفس] thinks about. Al-Ḥillī reconstructs the argument as follows. If the intellectual faculty inhered in such an organ, either the organ's form would suffice for its being understood, or it would not. If it sufficed, the soul would think of the organ continuously, because that form would always be present. If it did not, a second form of the same organ would be required, producing the prohibited coincidence of two similar forms. The soul would consequently either understand its receptacle always or never. Yet it thinks of the heart or brain sometimes and not at other times. The intermittent occurrence is therefore intellection [التعقل] of the supposed receptacle, which supplies the objection to inherence. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 186.)

contrary [الضد] occurs [its intellectual faculty [القوة] grows stronger through repeated activity]. §345 Their inclusion under one definition entails their unity [الوحدة] [in species]. §346 Differences in accidents [العرض] do not entail differences [in the souls [النفس]' species].

§347 Souls [النفس] originate in time. This is evident on our view; on the opponent's view, were they beginningless, opposites would coincide, what has been established would be invalidated, or what is impossible would be established.

§348 Souls [النفس] and bodies [البدن] correspond one to one.[68]

§349 The soul [النفس] does not perish when the body [البدن] perishes. §350 Nor does it become the principle of a form [الصورة] for another [body] [البدن]; otherwise the correspondence we have established would be invalidated. §351 It apprehends intelligibles [المعقول] through itself, and perceives through instruments, since things differing in spatial position [الوضع] are distinguished without reference [to anything outside the perceiver].[69]

Faculties of the soul

§352 The soul [النفس] has faculties through which it shares [functions] with other living things: the faculties of nutrition, growth, and reproduction. §353 It has other, more specialized faculties by which apprehension [الإدراك] of either the particular or the universal [الكلي] occurs. §354 The nutritive faculty [القوة الغاذية] has the attractive, retentive, digestive, and expulsive [faculties]. §355 These may be duplicated for certain organs. §356 Growth and fattening are distinct.

§357 In my view, the formative faculty [القوة المصورة] is untenable, because these ordered, composite actions cannot proceed from a simple faculty wholly without awareness. §358 As for the faculties that perceive particulars, one is touch, which is spread throughout the whole body [البدن]. §359 Whether it is multiple is open to examination. §360 Another is taste, which requires the mediation of salivary moisture devoid of a like or contrary [الضد] [taste]. §361 Another is smell, which requires air affected [by an odour], or [particles of] the odorous body [الجسم], to reach the nasal cavity.[70]

§362 Another is hearing, which depends on compressed air reaching the auditory passage. §363 Another is sight, whose proper objects are light and color. §364 In us, sight consists in the pupil's being affected. §365 It necessarily occurs when its conditions are present.

§366 [It occurs] by the emission of a ray.[71]

§367 If the ray is reflected back to the perceiver, he sees his face. §368 If the two visual axes become separated, the object appears multiple. §369 Among these faculties is phantasia [بنطاسيا] [the common sense] [الحس المشترك], which judges among the objects of the senses. §370 [Its existence [الوجود] is shown] by seeing a falling drop as a line and a flame as a circle. §371 And by the delirious person's seeing what has no [external] actuality.

§372 And imagination [الخيال], because the receiving faculty must differ from the preserving faculty. §373 And estimation [الوهم], which apprehends particular meanings. §374 And memory [الحافظة] [which preserves those meanings]. §375 And the compositive imagination [المتخيلة], which combines forms [الصورة] and meanings with one another.

Chapter 5 · Accidents

§376 These are restricted to nine [categories].

Quantity

§377 First: Quantity [الكم]. Its continuous kinds whose parts coexist are [mathematical] body [الجسم], surface, and line; the kind whose parts do not coexist is time; and its discrete

[68] §348. Al-Ḥillī reads this as a numerical correspondence between souls [النفس] and bodies [البدن]. He gives a separate argument for each direction. If two souls belonged to one body, a person's immediately experienced single self would have to be two selves. If one soul belonged to two bodies, whatever was known through one would also be known through the other, and the same would apply to the other psychical attributes. Both consequences are rejected as contrary to what is immediately evident. The compressed expression "on equality" therefore excludes both several souls for one body and several bodies for one soul. It concerns the individuality of the soul–body relation considered here; the following discussion separately addresses whether the soul survives the body's dissolution. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 190.)

[69] §351. Ḥillī explains "without reference" as without reference to an external object: imagined right and left eyes remain distinguishable even when no external image exists. The argument concerns bodily instruments for particular perception, contrasted with the soul [النفس]'s unaided apprehension of universals.

[70] §361. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes two accounts: the surrounding air takes on the odour's quality, or particles detach from the odorous body [الجسم] and travel to the sense organ. He understands Ṭūsī as allowing both.

[71] §366. Al-Ḥillī describes the outward-ray theory as a cone extending from the eye to the visible object, with its apex at the pupil, and expressly attributes this choice to Ṭūsī. He contrasts Avicenna's account of the visible form being imprinted in the eye's crystalline humour, then rejects both theories himself. Against emission, he asks how a tiny eye could supply a body extending to the fixed stars and how such a subtle ray could escape disturbance by wind. Against imprinting, he objects to a large image's being received in something small. These criticisms belong to the commentator. The positive reading "by the emission of a ray" occurs both in the electronic Āmulī text and in al-Jalālī's matn, p.161, checked against the scan. No negation has been supplied to reconcile it with the preceding reference to the pupil's being affected. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 197.)

kind is number.[72] §378 They all admit equality and its absence, division, and the possible existence [الوجود] of a unit that measures them. §379 Quantity [الكم] is either intrinsic or accidental. §380 In both divisions, the second member can occur in the first [discreteness in continuity, and accidental quantity [الكم] in intrinsic quantity]. §381 The presence of what is incompatible [with contrariety] [التضاد], and the absence of its condition, indicate that contrariety is absent [from quantity] [الكم].

§382 Quantity [الكم] is described by increase and multiplicity [الكثرة] and their opposites, but not by intensity and its opposite. §383 The species of continuous quantity [الكم] may be mathematical. §384 Although they differ in a certain manner of consideration. §385 The exclusion of substantiality [الجوهرية] from what is given in answer to "What is it?" in each case indicates its accidentality [العرضية]. §386 Change while the reality [الحقيقة] remains, the need to prove finitude, the existence [الثبوت] of a true sphere, dependence on an accident [العرض], and constitution by it indicate, respectively, the accidentality [العرضية] of mathematical body [الجسم التعليمي], surface, line, time, and number.

§387 Extremities are not nonexistences, although they are described by nonexistence [العدم] together with a kind of relation [الإضافة]. §388 The genus [الجنس] [quantity] [الكم] is the bearer of finitude and its [privative] absence.[73] §389 Both are conceptual considerations.

Quality

§390 Second: Quality [الكيف]. It is characterized by negative qualifications that, taken together, distinguish it from everything else. §391 Its divisions are four. §392 Sensible qualities [الكيفية] are either affective qualities [الكيفيات الانفعالية] or affections [الانفعالات] [depending on their stability].[74] §393 They differ from shapes because different things are predicated of them. §394 And [they differ] from temperament [المزاج], because they are more general.

Tangible qualities and inclination

§395 Among them are the primary tangible qualities [الكيفية]: heat, cold, moisture, and dryness. The remainder are referred to these. §396 Heat gathers together things of like nature and separates things of unlike nature; cold does the reverse. §397 The two are contraries [الضد]. §398 "Heat" is also applied to other meanings differing in reality [الحقيقة] from the [sensible] quality [الكيفية]. §399 Moisture is a quality [الكيفية] entailing ease of taking shape; dryness is the reverse.

§400 They differ from softness and hardness. §401 Heaviness is a quality [الكيفية] entailing the body [الجسم]'s movement to where its center coincides with the center of the world, if heaviness is absolute. Lightness is the reverse. The terms are also used relatively, in two respects. §402 Inclination [الميل] is natural, forced, or psychical. §403 It is the proximate cause [العلة القريبة] of motion [الحركة], and through it something changing proceeds from something constant.

§404 [Inclinations] [الميل] differing [in direction] are contrary [الضد].[75]

§405 Without its existence [الثبوت], what has an impediment would be equal [in motion] [الحركة] to what lacks one.[76] §406 According to others, it is a genus [الجنس] with [species] corresponding to the number of directions, and its instances are alike or different in respect of those directions. §407 Heaviness is one of its kinds; others among them regard it as different. §408 Some inclination [الميل] is inseparable, and some separable. §409 It requires a receptacle [المحل], and only one.

[72] §377. Al-Ḥillī defines qārr al-dhāt through the coexistence of its parts and contrasts it with time, whose different portions cannot coexist. 'Body [الجسم]' here is mathematical body [الجسم التعليمي], or three-dimensional magnitude, rather than substance [الجوهر].

[73] §388. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes privative nonfinitude, which presupposes quantity [الكم], from mere negation of finitude, which can be said of things without quantity. This keeps the assertion from attributing positive infinite magnitude to everything that is not finite.

[74] §392. "Affective qualities [الكيفيات الانفعالية]" and "affections [الانفعالات]" render the traditional distinction between relatively stable sensible qualities [الكيفية] and transient sensible states. They do not refer specifically to emotion.

[75] §404. The things declared contrary [الضد] are inclinations [الميل] toward different directions. Al-Ḥillī argues that an inclination directs a body toward one direction and away from another, so two incompatible inclinations cannot both govern it in the same respect. He nevertheless distinguishes an intrinsic inclination from one belonging to a body incidentally. A stone carried by a moving person retains its own heaviness while sharing the person's movement. When a forced cause opposes a natural inclination, the causes contend and the body's actual inclination reflects the stronger. Al-Ḥillī describes the forced inclination's weakening, an intermediate balance without inclination, and the subsequent strengthening of the natural inclination. The assertion thus excludes the simultaneous full operation of opposed inclinations in the same respect, while allowing the distinctions and successive intermediate conditions he explains. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 214.)

[76] §405. Al-Ḥillī understands this as an argument for natural inclination [الميل] in a body capable of forced motion [الحركة]. The natural inclination supplies an internal resistance; the ratio argument compares motion with and without resistance.

§410 It lies within our power [القدرة]. §411 Things are generated from it: some by its own nature without a condition, some under a condition, and some not by its own nature [but through an intermediary].

Color and light

§412 Among [sensible qualities] [الكيفية] are the primary visible qualities, color and light. §413 Each has two extremes. §414 The former [color] has a reality [الحقيقة] of its own. §415 Its two extremes are blackness and whiteness, which are contraries [الضد]. §416 It depends on the latter [light] for being perceived, not for existing.

§417 The two [color and light] are perceptibly different. §418 Both admit intensity and weakness; [the intense and weak instances] differ in species. §419 If the latter [light] were a body [الجسم], the result would contradict what the senses perceive. §420 Rather, it is an accident [العرض] inhering in a receptacle [المحل]; it prepares what faces that receptacle to acquire a similar [quality]. §421 It is intrinsic or accidental, primary or secondary.

§422 Darkness is a privation [عدم الملكة].

Sound, letters, and speech

§423 Among [sensible qualities] are audible things: sounds arising from undulation caused by striking and pulling apart. §424 On condition of resistance. §425 [Sound occurs] outside [the ear]. §426 Its persistence is impossible, because the formal configuration [الهيئة الصورية] [of successive sounds] must be perceived. §427 Another [sound] arises from it [as an echo].

§428 A sound bears a distinguishing quality [الكيفية], in virtue of which it is called a letter. §429 [A letter] is either a vowel or a consonant; [consonants] are alike or different, intrinsically or accidentally. §430 Speech, in its various divisions, is composed of them. §431 No other [kind of speech] is intelligible.[77]

Tastes and smells

§432 Among [sensible qualities] [الكيفية] are the nine tastes, arising from the interaction of three [qualities] with an equal number [of others]. §433 And smells: their species have no names except in respect of agreeableness or disagreeableness.

Dispositions

§434 [Another class comprises] dispositions [الاستعداد] intermediate between the two sides of contradiction [التناقض] [existence [الوجود] and nonexistence] [العدم].

Psychical qualities

§435 Psychical qualities [الكيفيات النفسانية] are either passing states [الحال] or established dispositions [الملكة].

Knowledge

§436 Among them is knowledge [العلم]: either conception [التصور], or assent [التصديق] that is firm, corresponds [to its object], and is stable.[78] §437 It is not susceptible to definition. §438 Both [conception [التصور] and assent] [التصديق] divide into non-inferential [الضروري] and acquired [knowledge] [العلم]. §439 [Knowledge] [العلم] requires the impression [of a form] [الصورة]. §440 In an immaterial receptacle [المحل] capable of receiving it.

§441 The inherence of a likeness differs [from the inherence of the thing itself]. §442 Union [of intellect [العقل] and intelligible] [المعقول] is impossible. §443 [Knowledge] [العلم] differs according to differences in what is understood. §444 As with the present and the future. §445 It can be understood only in relation [to an object]; the difficulty is therefore greater when there is identity [of knower and known].[79]

§446 It is an accident [العرض], because the definition [of an accident] applies to it. §447 It is active, passive, or neither. §448 And non-inferential [الضروري], with six divisions, or acquired. §449 And necessary or possible [in its existence] [الوجود]. §450 It follows [the known], in the sense that what corresponds to it [the known] is primary in their correspondence.

§451 Thus the circularity [الدور] is removed. §452 It requires preparedness: for non-inferential knowledge [العلم الضروري], through the senses; for acquired knowledge [العلم الكسبي], through the former [non-inferential knowledge].

[77] §431. Ḥillī explains this as denying a kind of speech beyond the articulated speech just defined; the immediate polemical target is speech conceived as an additional inner attribute.

[78] §436. Here "knowledge [العلم]" is used broadly enough to include conception [التصور] as well as true, firm, stable assent [التصديق]. Subsequent clauses distinguish this broad usage from narrower epistemic usages. "Non-inferential" renders epistemic ḍarūrī and does not mean metaphysical necessity.

[79] §445. The difficulty concerns self-knowledge [العلم]: if knowledge is an impressed likeness and a relation, how can knower and known be identical? The main text raises the difficulty tersely; it does not state the full attempted solutions discussed by Ḥillī.

§453 In one usage, knowledge [العلم] differs from apprehension [الإدراك] as a species differs from its genus [الجنس]; in another, they differ as two species.[80]

§454 Complete knowledge [العلم] of the cause [العلة] entails complete knowledge of the effect [المعلول].[81]

§455 Its degrees are three.

§456 What has a cause [السبب] is known only through its cause, in a universal [الكلي] manner.[82]

§457 Intellect [العقل] is an innate disposition [الغريزة] entailing knowledge [العلم] of non-inferential [الضروري] truths when the instruments are sound. §458 The term is applied to other things equivocally.

Belief, doubt, and opinion

§459 "Belief [الاعتقاد]" is applied to one of the two divisions of knowledge [العلم] [assent] [التصديق]. §460 Thus the relations [النسبة] of generality and specificity between belief [الاعتقاد] and knowledge [العلم] are reversed [under different usages]. §461 Contrariety [التضاد] occurs in belief [الاعتقاد], unlike knowledge [العلم]. §462 Inattention is a privation [عدم الملكة] of knowledge [العلم]; it may be distinguished from forgetting. §463 Doubt is the mind's wavering between the two alternatives.

§464 Both belief [الاعتقاد] and knowledge [العلم] can have themselves and one another as objects; the difference is then one of consideration, not of forms [الصورة]. §465 Ignorance in one sense is opposed to both; in another sense it is a division of one of them [belief] [الاعتقاد]. §466 Opinion [الظن] is giving preponderance to one of two alternatives; it differs from believing that there is such preponderance.

§467 It admits intensity and weakness, and its two extremes are knowledge [العلم] and [simple] ignorance.[83]

Reflection and proof

§468 It is self-evident that acquired knowledge [العلم الكسبي] results from reflection [النظر] when both its parts [matter [المادة] and form] [الصورة] are sound.[84] §469 When either is defective, the contrary [الضد] [ignorance] may result. §470 The production of knowledge [العلم] by sound reflection [النظر] is necessary. §471 There is no need for a teacher. §472 There must, however, be the formal part [الجزء الصوري] [the proper arrangement of the premises].

§473 Reflection [النظر] requires both the absence of its goal [knowledge [العلم] of what is sought] and the absence of that goal's contrary [الضد] [false conviction], while what is sought must be present [as a question in the mind].[85]

[80] §453. The comparison depends on two terminological conventions. In the first, "knowledge [العلم]" means apprehension [الإدراك] of universals, such as colour or taste considered generally. "Apprehension" covers that cognition together with sensory awareness of particulars, such as this colour or this taste. Apprehension is consequently the genus [الجنس] and knowledge one of its species. In the second convention, "apprehension" is restricted to sensation [الإحساس]. Sensation and knowledge then count as two species under apprehension understood broadly. Al-Ḥillī explicitly assigns the genus and species in the first comparison, resolving the compressed ordering of the Arabic sentence. The passage records different usages of the terms. It does not require the reader to treat knowledge and apprehension as having one fixed extension throughout every subsequent argument. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 232.)

[81] §454. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes three ways of knowing a cause [العلة]. Knowing only its quiddity [الماهية] as a thing of a certain nature does not by itself yield knowledge [العلم] of its effect [المعلول]. Knowing it as something that entails another thing yields a correspondingly incomplete knowledge of the effect: one knows it as consequent on the cause, without yet knowing its own quiddity. Complete knowledge of the cause includes its nature, consequences, concomitants, attributes, and relations to other things. It is this third kind that entails complete knowledge of the effect, whose nature is included among the cause's consequences. The repeated qualification "complete" is therefore essential. The proposition does not say that any acquaintance with a cause automatically provides full knowledge of everything it produces. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 232.)

[82] §456. Al-Ḥillī first explains the role of the cause [السبب]: considered solely in itself, a contingent thing [الممكن] does not determine a judgment that it exists or does not exist; its causal conditions determine that judgment. He then explains "universally" through a particular eclipse. One may know that eclipse through its causes and general conditions. The resulting cognition has a universal [الكلي] form: whenever such causes obtain, this eclipse or one like it follows. The event's individuality does not turn that causal account into sensory apprehension of a particular as such. The qualification therefore concerns the mode of causal knowledge [العلم]. It should not be expanded into a general denial that particulars can be perceived, or into a claim that a particular eclipse cannot be known through its causes. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 233.)

[83] §467. The subject is opinion, understood as a judgment in favour of one alternative without excluding its contradictory. Al-Ḥillī says that this preponderance has degrees, which explains why opinion admits strength and weakness. At the strongest limit stands knowledge [العلم], beyond which there is no further degree of preponderance. At the weakest stands simple ignorance, which he expressly identifies here with pure doubt: neither alternative has any preponderance. This endpoint is therefore different from compound ignorance, discussed earlier, in which a person holds a false conviction. The sentence describes the scale on which opinion varies. It does not identify stronger opinion with increased false certainty or make false conviction the necessary opposite endpoint to knowledge. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 238.)

[84] §468. The claim here concerns the self-evidence of sound reflection [النظر]'s efficacy; the following claim at 470 concerns the necessity of knowledge [العلم] resulting from sound reflection. This distinction follows Ḥillī's explanation of the two passages.

[85] §473. Al-Ḥillī resolves the apparent requirement that the goal be both

§474 The obligation to reflect is rational: what the two rational duties [gratitude and removal of fear] depend upon is obligatory; and supposing the contrary of the desired conclusion [that the obligation depends solely on revelation] would negate that contrary itself. §475 What entails knowledge [العلم] is a proof; what entails opinion [الظن] is an indication. §476 Its simple constituents [premises] are rational or mixed [rational and transmitted], because circularity [الدور] is impossible. §477 Verbal evidence may yield certainty. §478 It must be interpreted when there is conflict [with another transmitted proof or with rational proof].

§479 Proof is either syllogism [القياس] or one of the two other divisions [induction [الاستقراء] and analogy] [التمثيل].

Syllogistic forms

§480 Syllogism [القياس] is either conjunctive [الاقتراني] or exceptive [الاستثنائي].[86] §481 The former has four divisions in respect of its proximate form [الصورة], and two in respect of its remote form.[87] §482 And five in respect of its proximate matter [المادة], and four in respect of its remote matter.[88] §483 The latter, when implicative, yields two valid forms; so too when its disjunction is nonexclusive or nonexhaustive. A strict disjunction yields twice that number.[89] §484 The last two [induction [الاستقراء] and analogy] [التمثيل] yield opinion [الظن]. The details of these matters are treated in another discipline.

Intellection and immateriality

§485 Intellection [التعقل] and immateriality [التجرد] entail one another. Division of the receptacle [المحل] would entail division of what inheres: if [the parts] were alike, position would belong to what is immaterial; otherwise it would be composed of infinitely many parts. §486 And because immateriality [التجرد] entails the possibility [الإمكان] of being understood, which entails the possibility of association [with another intelligible] [المعقول].

Power

§487 Among [psychical qualities] [الكيفيات النفسانية] is power [القدرة]. It differs from nature because it is accompanied by awareness, and from temperament [المزاج] because what follows from it [its effects] is different. §488 It makes the act possible in relation [النسبة] [to the agent]. §489 It extends to both alternatives.

§490 It precedes the act: because the unbeliever is subject to obligation; because of incompatibility [on the contrary hypothesis]; and because, without its priority [التقدم], one of two impossibilities would follow.[90]

§491 A single act cannot be brought about by more than one possessor of power [القدرة].[91] §492 There is no implausibility in powers [القدرة] being alike. §493 Power [القدرة] is opposed to incapacity [العجز] as possession [الملكة] is opposed to privation [عدم الملكة]. §494 Power [القدرة] and character differ because contrary [الضد] judgments apply to them; [character also differs] from the act.[92]

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absent and present by distinguishing achieved knowledge [العلم] from the question being investigated. Knowledge of the object sought must be absent, since inquiry would otherwise seek something already attained. Compound ignorance must also be absent: someone convinced that he already knows will not seek the knowledge he lacks. Yet the object sought must be present to the mind as something to investigate, because one cannot seek what one is wholly unaware of. The three conditions thus concern different respects: the desired knowledge is missing, a blocking false conviction is missing, and the question is mentally available. Al-Ḥillī introduces this explicitly as his understanding of the compressed sentence. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 241.)

[86] §480. Conjunctive [الاقتراني] (iqtirānī) syllogisms contain the conclusion only potentially in their premises. Exceptive [الاستثنائي] (istithnā'ī) syllogisms explicitly affirm or deny a component of a conditional or disjunctive premise.

[87] §481. Ḥillī identifies the four proximate forms [الصورة] as the four syllogistic figures and the two remote forms as categorical and conditional.

[88] §482. The five kinds by proximate matter [المادة] are demonstration, dialectic, rhetoric, sophistry, and poetry. The four kinds by remote matter are accepted, probable, specious, and imaginative premises, according to Ḥillī's explanation.

[89] §483. The two implicative forms are affirming the antecedent and denying the consequent. A disjunction that is exclusive without necessarily being exhaustive, or exhaustive without necessarily being exclusive, permits two forms; a strict disjunction, both exclusive and exhaustive, permits four.

[90] §490. The conclusion is that power exists before the act. Al-Ḥillī's first argument concerns an unbeliever's obligation to believe: if the person had no power to believe before believing, the obligation would require what he could not do. He initially explains "incompatibility" as making the act both dependent on power and independent of it if power exists only when the act has already emerged. He then reads the "two impossibilities" as the temporal origination of divine power or the beginninglessness of the act. He also offers a second interpretation of the last two clauses. Since power extends to opposed acts, strict concurrence would threaten their simultaneous occurrence; the alternative forces a priority [التقدم] incompatible with the assumed concurrence. These are alternative explanations supplied by the commentator. The translation preserves Ṭūsī's compressed wording without silently selecting either explanation as his express statement. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 248.)

[91] §491. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes one act being within the power [القدرة] of two agents from its actually being produced by both. He permits the former if the act is realised through one of them; his objection to joint production treats each power as sufficient for the act in its own right.

[92] §494. Following Ḥillī, "and the act" is taken to add that character differs from the act, after distinguishing character from power [القدرة].

Pain and pleasure

§495 Among [psychical qualities] [الكيفيات النفسانية] are pain and pleasure. They are two species of apprehension [الإدراك], distinguished by a relation [الإضافة] that varies according to what they are compared with.

§496 Pleasure is not merely departure from the natural state.[93]

§497 Pain may be grounded in the disruption of continuity. §498 Each is either sensory or intellectual; the latter is stronger.

Will, aversion, and life

§499 Among [psychical qualities] [الكيفيات النفسانية] are will [الإرادة] and aversion [الكراهة], which are two species of knowledge [العلم] [in the broad sense].[94]

§500 One entails the other when [their objects] are opposed.[95] §501 They are considered differently in relation [النسبة] to the agent and in relation to someone else. §502 They may concern themselves, unlike appetite and repugnance.

§503 These qualities [الكيفية] require life. In our case, life is a characteristic entailing sensation and movement and is conditioned by equilibrium of temperament [المزاج].[96]

§504 Thus a bodily structure is necessary. §505 [Life] requires the vital spirit [الروح]. §506 It is opposed to death as possession [الملكة] is opposed to privation [عدم الملكة].

Other psychical qualities

§507 Among psychical qualities [الكيفيات النفسانية] are health and disease. §508 And joy and distress. §509 And anger, sorrow, worry, shame, and rancor.

Qualities of quantity

§510 Qualities [الكيفية] specific to quantity [الكم] concern either continuous quantity, such as straightness, circularity, curvature, concavity, convexity, shape, and appearance; or discrete quantity, such as evenness and oddness. §511 The straight line is the shortest of the lines joining two points. Just as it exists, so does the circle. §512 There is no contrariety [التضاد] between the straight and the circular; nor, therefore, between their [corresponding] attributes. §513 Shape is the configuration in which a boundary or boundaries encompass a body [الجسم]; with the addition of color, appearance results.

Relation

§514 Third: The Relative. §515 It is either relative in the strict sense [المضاف الحقيقي] or in ordinary usage [the relation [الإضافة] itself or the thing bearing it]. §516 It necessarily involves reciprocity and parity [of the correlatives], in actuality [الفعل] or potentiality [القوة]. §517 It occurs in all existents.

§518 Its existence [الثبوت] is mental; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow. Saying that relation [الإضافة] is relative in itself does not help.[97]

Character (khuluq) is an established disposition from which acts issue easily.

[93] §496. The principal reading in both the electronic text and al-Jalālī's matn, p.176, says "departure from the natural state." Al-Jalālī's apparatus records "nonnatural" in one witness and cites Qūshjī's fuller reading, "departure from the nonnatural state into the natural state." The latter yields the familiar rejection of defining pleasure merely as restoration to the natural state. The translation preserves the printed principal reading. Al-Ḥillī reports the account under discussion from Muḥammad ibn Zakariyyā, then objects that it substitutes an accidental accompaniment for pleasure's essence. His example is pleasure in seeing an image for the first time, where there need have been no preceding painful longing for that image. This explains the argumentative point, but does not remove the textual uncertainty between the competing formulations of the definition. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 251.)

[94] §499. "Knowledge [العلم]" has a broad sense here. Al-Ḥillī explains will [الإرادة] as a living agent's knowledge, belief, or opinion that an act contains a benefit, and aversion [الكراهة] as the corresponding assessment that it contains a harm. The classification therefore does not require that the assessment be certain or true. He identifies this with one position in a dispute, then reports another: will and aversion are additional inclinations arising after the cognitive assessment, since we find ourselves tending toward or away from what we judge beneficial or harmful. He also distinguishes will from appetite. A sick person may will to drink medicine while having no appetite for it. This example clarifies the psychological distinctions without turning the alternative position into the view asserted by Ṭūsī's sentence. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 252.)

[95] §500. This follows Ḥillī's first reading: willing a thing entails aversion to its opposite. He also suggests that the clause may mean that knowledge [العلم] entails one or the other of will and aversion, depending on benefit or harm. The Arabic is exceptionally compressed.

[96] §503. Al-Ḥillī says that the psychical qualities [الكيفيات النفسانية] just discussed require life, then explains the qualification "in our case." It restricts both the account of life as entailing sensation and movement and the condition that temperament [المزاج] be in equilibrium. He expressly contrasts the life of the Necessary Existent [واجب الوجود], which requires no balanced temperament and entails neither sensation nor movement. The general dependence of these qualities [الكيفية] on life is thus distinguished from the particular account of our life. The qualification must remain attached to the whole physiological description. Attaching it only to equilibrium of temperament would leave sensation and movement as unrestricted requirements of life, contrary to the commentator's explicit explanation. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 253.)

[97] §518. Al-Ḥillī identifies the mental existence [الوجود الذهني] of relation [الإضافة] as Ṭūsī's position. The regress argument runs through inherence: if fatherhood is an externally existing accident [العرض] in a father, its inhering in him is itself a relation; treating that inherence as

§519 And because its existence [الوجود] would precede [its own existence].[98] §520 And an infinity [of relations] [الإضافة] would follow at every position in the series of numbers. §521 And the attributes of God Most High would be multiplied.

§522 Every relative in ordinary usage [المضاف المشهوري] has its own relative in the strict sense [المضاف الحقيقي]. Difference and agreement therefore occur in the latter. [The relation [الإضافة] belongs to its bearer] either through an additional factor or without one.[99]

Place and motion

§523 Fourth: Where, which is relation [النسبة] to place. §524 According to some, its species are four: motion [الحركة], rest [السكون], conjunction, and separation. §525 Motion [الحركة] is the first perfection [الكمال الأول] of what is potential, insofar as it is potential; or the body [الجسم]'s being in one place after another. §526 Its existence [الوجود] is self-evident. §527 It depends on the two opposites [starting point and endpoint], the two causes [mover and moved], that to which it is referred [the category in which it occurs], and its measure [time].

§528 The starting point and endpoint may have the same locus, or may be contrary [الضد] intrinsically or accidentally. §529 They have two opposed considerations, one with reference to that of which they are predicated [and the other with reference to each other]. §530 If the two causes were identical, the effect [المعلول] [motion] [الحركة] would not occur. §531 And [motion] [الحركة] would be universal [to all bodies] [الجسم]. §532 This differs from nature, which varies and entails [motion [الحركة] only] in a certain condition.

§533 There are four [categories] to which motion [الحركة] is referred. For simple substances [الجوهر] come into existence [الوجود] all at once, and composite substances cease to exist when [one of] their parts ceases to exist.[100]

§534 The relative is dependent [on other categories]. §535 So too is when. §536 Having comes about all at once. §537 No motion [الحركة] is intelligible in the categories of acting and being acted upon.

The categories in which motion occurs

§538 In quantity [الكم], [motion [الحركة] occurs] in two respects: [rarefaction and condensation, as shown] by water entering a vessel inverted upon it, and by vessels bursting when their contents boil. §539 And [growth, as shown] by the proportional movement of the parts of what is nourished in all dimensions. §540 In quality [الكيف], [motion [الحركة] occurs] because alteration is perceived, while concealment and influx [as explanations] are certainly false, since sense perception [الحس] refutes both.[101] §541 In place and position it is evident. §542 Unity [الوحدة] occurs in motion [الحركة] through the unity of its measure, locus, and recipient.[102]

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another externally existing accident requires a further inherence, and so on. He then reports Avicenna's reply that a relation is relative by itself, whereas another thing is relative through it. Fatherhood need not acquire a further relation in order to be related to its correlate. Al-Ḥillī answers that this addresses a different dependency. The objection concerns the relation's subsistence in its bearer, rather than its being related to a correlate through another relation. The final clause rejects the proposed reply on that basis; it is not an unexplained denial that relative concepts have correlates. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 258.)

[98] §519. The pronoun is ambiguous. Ḥillī first understands the argument as requiring the existence [الوجود] of relation to precede its own existence; he also allows "its receptacle [المحل]" as the referent. The first interpretation supplies the bracketed words.

[99] §522. A relative "in ordinary usage" is a bearer such as a father; the relative "in the strict sense" is fatherhood itself. Al-Ḥillī says that each bearer has its own relation [الإضافة], since one numerically identical accident [العرض] cannot inhere in two subjects. The relations can differ in kind, as fatherhood and sonship do, or agree, as the corresponding instances of brotherhood and neighbourhood do. The final clause introduces a further distinction: how the relation belongs to its bearer. Love involves additional features in lover and beloved; knowledge [العلم] supplies an additional feature in the knower; being to the right or left requires no such further quality. On al-Ḥillī's reading, 'through an additional factor or without one' qualifies the relation's occurrence in its bearer, rather than the preceding contrast between agreement and difference. He closes by identifying this as his understanding of the compressed wording. Agreement does not mean that one accident occupies two bearers. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 260.)

[100] §533. Al-Ḥillī identifies the four categories as quantity, quality, place, and position. The remainder explains why substance [الجوهر] is excluded. A simple substance comes into existence [الوجود] all at once, so its coming to be is not the gradual process classified as motion [الحركة]. A composite substance ceases to be when one of its constituent parts ceases to be. Yet the moving subject must persist through the motion; the composite, considered in the substantial change at issue, does not persist in that way. The commentator explicitly glosses the plural "parts" with "one of its parts," which justifies the supplied wording. The argument therefore does not require the loss of every constituent. Its concern is which categories admit motion, while preserving a subject that remains throughout the change. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 265.)

[101] §540. "Concealment" (kumūn) explains apparent alteration as the emergence of a previously hidden quality [الكيف]; "influx" (wurūd) explains it by entry of something from outside. The text rejects both as general substitutes for genuine qualitative alteration.

[102] §542. The measure is time. Ḥillī takes the remaining terms as the subject and the category in which motion [الحركة] occurs, but explicitly allows "locus" and "recipient" to exchange those references. The translation preserves the general terms.

§543 Difference in the two opposites and in that to which motion [الحركة] is referred entails difference [in motion]. §544 And contrariety [التضاد] in the first two entails contrariety [of motions] [الحركة]. §545 Neither the two opposites nor the agent has a role in [motion [الحركة]'s] division. §546 Motion [الحركة] has a quality [الكيفية] that makes it fast when intensified and slow when weakened. The quiddity [الماهية] of motion does not differ on that account. §547 The cause [السبب] of slowness is external or internal resistance, not intervening rests; otherwise what possesses the opposite [speed] would not be perceived.

§548 Motions [الحركة] involving angles or reversal are not continuous, because an interval of time lies between the two instants of inclination [الميل].[103]

Rest and kinds of spatial state

§549 Rest [السكون] preserves relations [النسبة]; it is therefore a contrary [الضد] [of motion] [الحركة]. §550 It is opposed to both motions [الحركة] [toward and away from the place of rest].[104] §551 Outside the category of where, [rest [السكون] is] the preservation of the species [of state within the category]. §552 Instances of rest [السكون] are contrary [الضد] because what they occur in is contrary. §553 Among spatial states [motion [الحركة] and rest] [السكون], some are natural, some forced, and some voluntary.[105]

§554 Natural motion [الحركة] occurs only when something unnatural accompanies [the body] [الجسم]. §555 To return the body [الجسم] to its natural condition, at which point it comes to rest [السكون]. §556 Thus it cannot be circular. §557 Forced motion [الحركة] rests on an acquired force [القوة] capable of weakening. §558 Natural rest [السكون] is grounded in nature without qualification.

§559 Simplicity [البساطة] and its opposite [composition] [التركيب] occur in motion [الحركة] alone [among these spatial states]. §560 Neither the genus [الجنس] nor its species is explained by what entails circularity [الدور].

Time and when

§561 Fifth: When, which is relation [النسبة] to time or its extremity.

§562 Time is the measure of motion [الحركة] in respect of priority [التقدم] and posteriority, which belong to motion under a different consideration [that of distance, rather than time itself].[106]

§563 This category belongs intrinsically to changing things, and accidentally to their bearer. §564 The existence [الوجود] and nonexistence [العدم] of its bearer do not depend on time.[107] §565 The extremity [the instant] is like the point; its nonexistence [العدم] occurs in time without being gradual. §566 The origination [الحدوث] of the world entails the origination of time.

Position

§567 Sixth: Position, a configuration occurring in a body [الجسم] in respect of two relations [النسبة] [among its parts, and between its parts and external things]. §568 It admits contrariety [التضاد], intensity, and weakness.

Possession

§569 Seventh: Possession [الملك], which is the relation [النسبة] of having.

Acting and being acted upon

§570 Eighth and Ninth: Acting and Being Acted Upon. §571 The truth is that these two have mental existence [الوجود الذهني]; otherwise an infinite regress [التسلسل] would follow.[108]

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[103] §548. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes motion [الحركة] along two lines meeting at an angle from a reversal that returns from the endpoint toward the starting point. His argument requires an interval of rest between the respective straight motions. The inclination [الميل] producing arrival exists at the instant of arrival; the inclination producing departure cannot exist at that same instant, since the two incompatible inclinations cannot coexist. Nor can two distinct instants be immediately adjacent. A temporal interval must therefore separate them, during which the body lacks inclination and is at rest. This is the reasoning behind the denial of continuity. The asserted interval of rest is the conclusion of that argument, whose premises concern incompatible inclinations and the impossibility of adjacent instants. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 270.)

[104] §550. The bracket follows Ḥillī's first interpretation: rest is opposed both to movement from its place and to movement into it. He also allows "the two motions [الحركة]" to mean rectilinear and circular motion.

[105] §553. Kawn here is the genus [الجنس] of bodily occupation of place, encompassing motion [الحركة] and rest [السكون], not origination or existence [الوجود] in its unrestricted metaphysical sense.

[106] §562. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes priority [التقدم] and posteriority in the traversed distance from priority and posteriority in time. A portion of motion [الحركة] occurring at an earlier part of the path precedes one at a later part. The spatial parts can coexist, although the corresponding portions of motion cannot. Motion also has earlier and later temporal portions, but these cannot explain time's definition without circularity. "Under a different consideration" accordingly directs the reader to the order of the distance rather than to an already assumed temporal order. Time is then the measure or number of motion in respect of that priority and posteriority. The qualification prevents the definition from explaining time through time; it does not deny that motion itself can also be measured and ordered temporally. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 275.)

[107] §564. Ḥillī offers two interpretations of the bearer: the substrate [المحل] of changing states, or time itself as one term of the temporal relation. The translation leaves the reference open.

[108] §571. Ḥillī explicitly takes the pronoun to refer to the last two categories, acting and being acted upon. Their mental status is not a

Division 3
Establishing the Maker, exalted is He, His attributes, and His effects

This division comprises chapters.

Chapter 1 · His existence, exalted is He

§572 If an existent is necessary, [the desired conclusion follows]; otherwise, it entails [a necessary existent] [واجب الوجود], since circular dependence [الدور] and infinite regress [التسلسل] are impossible.[109]

Chapter 2 · His attributes

§573 The existence [الوجود] of the world after its nonexistence [العدم] excludes necessitation [الإيجاب] [by its cause].[110] §574 An intermediary [between God and everything other than Him] is unintelligible. §575 Necessity [الوجوب] and possibility [الإمكان] can accrue to an effect under two [different] considerations. §576 And power [القدرة] [to produce an effect] in the future can coexist with [its present] nonexistence [العدم]. §577 The absence of an act is not the performance of its contrary.

§578 The universality of the ground [of being subject to power] [القدرة] entails the universality of the attribute [of power].[111]

Divine knowledge

§579 [The world's] perfected order, [His] immateriality [التجرد], and the dependence of everything upon Him are proofs of [His] knowledge [العلم].[112]

§580 The last [proof] is universal [in its scope]. §581 The distinction [between knower and known in self-knowledge] [العلم] is one of consideration. §582 Knowledge [العلم] does not require forms distinct from the things known [to be present] with Him, because the relation of [those things'] presence to Him is stronger than the relation of intelligible forms [الصور المعقولة] to us. §583 Change in relations is possible [without change in His essence]. §584 Necessity [الوجوب] and possibility [الإمكان] can coexist under two [different] considerations.

Life

§585 Whatever possesses power [القدرة] and knowledge [العلم] is necessarily living.

Will

§586 Singling out some possible things for existence [الوجود] at a [particular] time indicates His will [الإرادة], exalted is He. §587 It is not additional to the motive [الداعي] [for acting]; otherwise, an infinite regress [التسلسل] or a plurality of beginningless entities would follow.

Perception

§588 Transmitted revelation [النقل] indicates that He possesses perception [الإدراك], and reason [العقل] [indicates] the impossibility of [His having perceptual] organs.

Speech and truthfulness

§589 The universality of His power [القدرة] indicates that speech [الكلام] is established [for Him]; internal speech [الكلام النفسي] (kalām nafsī) [as a distinct attribute] is unintelligible.[113]

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denial that effects occur.

[109] §572. Al-Ḥillī reconstructs the argument from the certainty that something exists. If that existent is necessary in itself, the required conclusion is already reached. If it is possible in itself, it requires an existing cause; the same question then arises about that cause. Circular dependence [الدور] and an endless succession of dependent causes have been rejected earlier in the work, so the explanation must terminate in a necessary existent [واجب الوجود]. Al-Ḥillī contrasts this with the theologians' argument from the world's temporal origination [الحدوث] to an originator. He says that the latter ultimately needs the former argument, since the originator's being without a beginning must still be connected with necessary existence [وجوب الوجود]. The brief lemma therefore relies on the earlier metaphysics of possibility [الإمكان], causation, circular dependence, and regress; it does not repeat their proofs here. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 279–281.)

[110] §573. The claim concerns a cause that produces its effect necessarily by its essence (mūjib), as opposed to a willing agent [الفاعل المختار]. It does not exclude the necessity of an effect once a willing agent's complete causal conditions obtain; the following clauses make this distinction.

[111] §578. Al-Ḥillī identifies the common ground as possibility [الإمكان]: everything possible falls within the scope of divine power [القدرة].

[112] §579. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes three arguments. The first infers knowledge [العلم] from the repeatedly ordered and skilful character of the world's production. The second connects immateriality [التجرد] with awareness of oneself and of other intelligibles [المعقول]. The third proceeds from God's knowledge of Himself as the cause on which everything else depends. The following lemma calls this last proof universal: it encompasses particulars and universals, substances [الجوهر] and accidents [العرض], and representations existing in minds. Even a mental representation of an impossibility is itself a possible existent and therefore falls within this dependence. In explaining the subsequent clauses, al-Ḥillī also rejects the assumption that divine knowledge requires additional images impressed in God. He treats the things known as present to their cause, and the distinction between knower and known in self-knowledge as a distinction of consideration. These are connected claims about the extent and manner of divine knowledge. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 284–286.)

[113] §589. The two halves distinguish different accounts of divine speech [الكلام]. Al-Ḥillī explains the first through God's power [القدرة] to produce letters and sounds in bodies, with those sounds signifying what He intends. Creating such sounds is possible and therefore falls within divine power. He reports that the Ash'arites accept this possibility [الإمكان] but also affirm an eternal meaning subsisting in God, distinct from knowledge [العلم], will, and the other attributes; verbal expressions

§590 The absence of badness [القبح] from Him, exalted is He, indicates His truthfulness [الصدق].

Eternity and attributes negated

§591 Necessity of existence [وجوب الوجود] indicates His eternity [السرمدية] and the negation of an additional [attribute of subsistence]. §592 And [it negates] a partner. §593 And a like. §594 And composition in its [various] senses. §595 And a contrary.

§596 And spatial occupation [التحيز]. §597 And inherence [الحلول] [in another]. §598 And union [الاتحاد] [with another]. §599 And [location in a] direction. §600 And the inherence [الحلول] of temporally originated things in Him.

§601 And need. §602 And pain absolutely, and pleasure arising from bodily temperament [المزاج]. §603 And entitative attributes [المعاني] (maʿānī), states [الأحوال] (aḥwāl), and attributes additional [to the essence] in concrete reality.

The vision of God

§604 And [His being an object of visual] seeing [الرؤية]. §605 Moses' request [to see God] was on behalf of his people.[114] §606 Looking does not imply seeing [الرؤية]; moreover, [the relevant expression] admits of interpretation. §607 Making seeing [الرؤية] conditional upon the moving mountain's remaining still does not indicate [the] possibility [الإمكان] [of seeing God]. §608 A common feature among effects does not indicate a common feature among their causes; moreover, [the need for] causal explanation and the exhaustiveness [of the proposed alternatives] are denied.

Other divine attributes

§609 And [necessity of existence [وجوب الوجود] indicates] the establishment of generosity [الجود] [in Him]. §610 And sovereignty [الملك]. §611 And completeness [التمام], and being above completeness. §612 And being the Real [الحق] (al-ḥaqq). §613 And goodness [الخيرية] (khayriyya).[115]

§614 And wisdom [الحكمة]. §615 And compelling might [التجبر] (tajabbur).[116] §616 And overpowering dominion [القهر] (qahr).[117] §617 And self-subsistence and the sustaining of others [القيومية] (qayyūmiyya). §618 As for hand, face, beginninglessness [القدم], mercy, munificence, good pleasure and bringing into being [التكوين], they refer back to what has preceded.[118]

Chapter 3 · His acts

§619 An act characterised by something additional [to its occurrence] is either good [الحسن] or bad [القبيح]; the good has four kinds.[119]

§620 Both [goodness [الحسن] and badness] [القبح] are rationally knowable, because the goodness of beneficence [الإحسان] and the badness of injustice [الظلم] are known without revelation.[120]

§621 And because both would disappear altogether if they were established [only] through revelation. §622 And [otherwise] their reversal would be possible. §623 Differences in [the evidentness of] cognitions are possible because of differences in conceptualisation. §624 And [the reply is] undertaking the less bad of two bad acts, together with the possibility [الإمكان] of a way out [of the dilemma].[121]

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signify that meaning. This is the 'internal speech [الكلام النفسي]' rejected in the second half. Al-Ḥillī's objection is conceptual: he says that a single meaning which is neither knowledge nor command, prohibition, report, or inquiry has not been rendered intelligible. Thus the assertion that God speaks is maintained, while this particular account of an additional eternal attribute is disputed. The passage presents the disagreement in al-Ḥillī's terms. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 289–290.)

[114] §605. This clause is present in the matn transmitted within al-Ḥillī's commentary used here; it is absent from the corresponding main text of al-Jalālī's edition, p. 194.

[115] §613. Al-Ḥillī explains this as pure existential goodness [الخيرية]: evil is the privation of a perfection due to a thing, whereas the Necessary Existent [واجب الوجود] lacks no perfection. This is distinct from the classification of acts as ḥasan or qabīḥ below.

[116] §615. Al-Ḥillī explains this attribute through God's bringing what is potential into actuality and completion; the term here is not a moral attribution of tyranny.

[117] §616. Al-Ḥillī explains qahr here as overcoming nonexistence [العدم] through existence [الوجود] and actualisation, just as he explains tajabbur at §615 through completing what is potential.

[118] §618. The unvocalised القدم is read qidam, 'beginninglessness [القدم]', following al-Ḥillī's explanation of a proposed attribute distinct from subsistence (baqā'). It is not translated as qadam, 'foot'.

[119] §619. Al-Ḥillī identifies the four as obligatory, recommended, permissible and disliked. 'Good [الحسن]' here means an act whose performance does not merit blame, so it includes the disliked.

[120] §620. 'Good' and 'bad' have a technical relation to praise and blame. In the preceding explanation, al-Ḥillī defines a good act as one whose performance does not incur blame. This broad category includes obligatory, recommended, permissible, and disliked acts: a disliked act may be better omitted without its performance deserving blame. The present argument claims that some moral judgments are immediately available to reason. Al-Ḥillī appeals to people who acknowledge no revealed law but nevertheless praise beneficence [الإحسان] and condemn injustice [الظلم]. The next argument concerns the justification of revelation itself: unless lying is independently known to be bad, one could not securely infer the goodness [الحسن] or badness [القبح] of an act from a divine report about it. These arguments explain why the author treats rational moral knowledge [العلم] as necessary to the ensuing account of divine justice [العدل]. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 302–303.)

[121] §624. This compressed reply concerns objections about lying to save a prophet and promising to lie. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes choosing the lesser wrong from the further possibility [الإمكان] of avoiding a lie by

§625 And compulsion [الجبر] [as an account of human action] is false.

Divine action and badness

§626 His independence and His knowledge [العلم] indicate the absence of badness [القبح] from His acts, exalted is He. §627 Although He has power [القدرة] over it [the bad], because [His power's] relation is universal; consequent impossibility [الامتناع اللاحق] does not conflict [with this power].

Purpose

§628 Denying a purpose entails pointlessness; [the benefit of] the purpose need not return to Him.

Will and human action

§629 Willing the bad is bad, as is failing to will the good; and [the same conclusion follows] from command and prohibition.[122]

§630 Some acts depend upon us; [God's] being overcome does not follow, and knowledge [العلم] follows [the thing known].[123]

Human agency

§631 It is immediately certain that our acts depend upon us. §632 Necessity [الوجوب] due to a motive [الداعي] does not conflict with power [القدرة], as [is also the case] with the Necessary Existent [واجب الوجود]. §633 Bringing into existence [الإيجاد] does not entail knowledge [العلم] unless accompanied by intention [القصد]; then general knowledge suffices. §634 When [the two powers] come together, what He wills, exalted is He, occurs. §635 Temporal origination [الحدوث] is a matter of consideration.

§636 The impossibility of [our producing] a body is due to something other than [temporal origination] [الحدوث].[124] §637 The inability to produce an exact likeness in some acts is due to the inability to comprehend [all their details]. §638 There is no comparison in goodness [الخيرية] between our act and His act, exalted is He. §639 Gratitude [to God] is for the prerequisites of faith [الإيمان]. §640 The transmitted evidence [السمع] [adduced against us] is interpreted and countered by its like; the grounds for preference favour us.

Generated acts

§641 The goodness [الحسن] of praise and blame for a generated act [الفعل المتولد] entails knowledge [العلم] that it is attributable to us.[125] §642 The necessity [الوجوب] [of the effect] through choosing its cause is consequent [necessity]. §643 In casting a child [into fire], blame concerns that [casting], not the burning.

Divine decree and determination

§644 If divine decree [القضاء] and determination [القدر] (qaḍā' and qadar) mean the creation of the [human] act, an impossibility follows; if they mean imposing obligation [الإلزام], [the assertion] is true only of what is obligatory; if they mean making known, it is true without restriction. The Commander of the Faithful, peace be upon him, explained this in the report of al-Aṣbagh.[126]

Guidance and misguidance

§645 Leading astray means pointing towards what is contrary to the truth, producing misguidance, or causing destruction. Guidance has the corresponding opposite

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equivocation; the clause is not a general instruction to choose wrongdoing when an innocent alternative exists.

[122] §629. Al-Ḥillī explains 'the good' in this argument through acts of obedience (ṭā'āt) and what God commands. It should not be read as saying that every merely permissible act, or every act falling under the broad technical category ḥasan at §619, must be willed.

[123] §630. Al-Ḥillī reads this as three replies to objections. First, the claim that God produces every existent cannot simply be used to assign human wrongdoing to Him: the authors maintain that some acts originate from human agents. Second, God's willing obedience does not entail His defeat when someone disobeys. The relevant will is that the person obey freely; al-Ḥillī distinguishes this from a will that the act occur regardless of whether it is chosen or compelled. Third, knowledge [العلم] of an act's occurrence does not alter the act's possibility [الإمكان] or produce it. 'Knowledge follows' expresses this explanatory relation to what is known. In the subsequent discussion, al-Ḥillī also distinguishes an act's being possible with respect to an agent's power from its becoming necessary given a prevailing motive [الداعي]. He presents that necessity as compatible with voluntary agency, applying the same distinction to divine action. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 307–309.)

[124] §636. This clause is present in the matn transmitted within al-Ḥillī's commentary used here; it is absent from the corresponding main text of al-Jalālī's edition, p. 199.

[125] §641. A generated act [الفعل المتولد] (mutawallid) is an effect produced through another act, rather than an act performed immediately. The clause distinguishes evidence that we already know its attribution from a demonstration of the attribution itself.

[126] §644. Al-Ḥillī first distinguishes senses of decree [القضاء] and determination [القدر] found in scriptural usage. These include creation, commanding or imposing an obligation [الإلزام], and making something known or recording it. The author's judgment consequently depends on which sense is intended. Creating the human act is rejected within the account of agency just defended; obligating it applies to duties; recording or announcing what people will do can apply generally. Al-Ḥillī adds that assent [التصديق] to divine decree cannot require approval of unbelief [الكفر] or other wrongdoing. The report transmitted through al-Aṣbagh illustrates the distinction: 'Alī is represented as affirming divine decree concerning the journey to Syria while denying that the travellers were compelled. Its argument connects their freedom with the intelligibility of reward [الثواب], punishment [العقاب], praise, blame, commands, and prohibitions. The report is being used as an interpretation of these theological terms. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 315–317.)

senses. The first two [senses of leading astray] are denied of Him, exalted is He.

Those not subject to moral obligation

§646 Punishing someone not subject to moral obligation [التكليف] is bad. Noah's words, peace be upon him, are figurative; [a child's] service is not a punishment [العقوبة] of him; and derivative status in some rulings is permissible.

Moral obligation

§647 Imposing moral obligation [التكليف] (taklīf) is good because it contains a benefit that cannot be obtained without it. §648 It differs from wounding and then treating [the wound], and from exchanges; [explaining it as repayment in] gratitude is invalid. §649 And because the [human] species needs mutual assistance, which requires an established law whose practice benefits [spiritual] discipline, sustained reflection upon higher matters, and recollection of warnings that lead to the establishment of justice [العدل], together with increased recompense and reward [الثواب]. §650 And [imposing moral obligation] [التكليف] is obligatory because it restrains [people] from bad acts.

§651 The conditions of its goodness [الحسن] are: the absence of a harmful consequence [of imposing the obligation]; its preceding [the act]; the possibility [الإمكان] of its object; the presence [in the act] of an attribute additional to its goodness; the imposer's knowledge [العلم] of the act's attributes and of the amount deserved [in reward] [الثواب], his power [القدرة] to [deliver] it, and the impossibility of badness [القبح] on his part; and the obligated person [المكلف]'s power to perform the act, his knowledge of it or ability [to acquire that knowledge], and the availability of the [required] instrument.[127]

§652 Its object is either knowledge [العلم], rational or transmitted; probable judgment [الظن]; or action. §653 It comes to an end, [as shown] by consensus [الإجماع] and [the need] to deliver reward [الثواب]. §654 The ground of its goodness [الحسن] is universal [for believer and unbeliever]. §655 The unbeliever's harm comes from his own choice. §656 It is a harm, but not insofar as [it arises from] the imposition of obligation [التكليف], unlike what we stipulated [must be absent].

§657 And the benefit [of offering the opportunity for reward] [الثواب] is established.

Gracious assistance

§658 Gracious assistance [اللطف] (luṭf) is obligatory because the purpose is attained through it.[128]

§659 If it is His act, exalted is He, it is obligatory upon Him. If it is the obligated person [المكلف]'s act, He must make him aware of it and require him to perform it. If it is the act of someone other than those two, knowing that the act [of assistance] will occur is a condition of [imposing] the obligation. §660 The grounds of badness [القبح] are absent [from it]; the unbeliever is not without gracious assistance [اللطف]; and announcing [someone's future] felicity or wretchedness is not a corrupting influence. §661 For Him, exalted is He, to punish while withholding it [gracious assistance] [اللطف] would be bad; to blame while withholding it would not.

§662 There must be a correspondence [between the assistance and the act assisted]; otherwise, there would be preference without a preferring ground in relation to the two related terms. §663 It does not reach the point of compulsion [الإلجاء]. §664 The obligated person [المكلف] must know the gracious assistance [اللطف], generally or in detail. §665 Gracious assistance [اللطف] has an aspect additional to [mere] goodness [الحسن]. §666 It admits of a choice [between alternatives].

§667 Provided that both alternatives are good.

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[127] §651. The unvocalised Arabic uses the same written form for the imposer of obligation and the person obligated; al-Ḥillī distinguishes their conditions. The obligation must leave sufficient time for the person to understand it and act. Its object must be possible and, for a positive act, obligatory or recommended, rather than merely permissible. The imposer must know the relevant moral features and the reward [الثواب] deserved, be able to provide it, and be incapable of wrongdoing. The obligated person [المكلف] must have the capacity, knowledge [العلم] or opportunity to acquire knowledge, and any necessary instrument. 'Harmful consequence' has a specific scope here: the obligation must not undermine this person's fulfilment of another obligation, or another person's fulfilment of theirs. It does not exclude the ordinary hardship intrinsic to moral obligation [التكليف], which the preceding discussion treats as compatible with its goodness [الحسن]. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 319, 322.)

[128] §658. Al-Ḥillī defines gracious assistance [اللطف] as something that brings an obligated person [المكلف] nearer to obedience and further from disobedience. It neither supplies the basic capacity to act nor compels the choice: an indispensable instrument belongs to enablement, while compulsion [الإلجاء] would defeat the conditions of moral responsibility. He distinguishes assistance that encourages obedience from assistance in whose presence obedience actually occurs freely, although the person could act in either case. The obligation to provide assistance follows from the purpose of imposing duties. His analogy is an invitation: someone who knows that a guest will accept only if shown a certain courtesy frustrates the invitation's purpose by withholding it. The following lemma distinguishes assistance supplied by God, performed by the obligated person, or supplied by a third party; the corresponding requirements differ with the agent responsible for it. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 324–325.)

Pain

§668 Some pain is bad and proceeds from us alone; some is good and proceeds from Him, exalted is He, and from us. Its goodness [الحسن] is either because it is deserved, because it includes a greater benefit or averts a greater harm, because it occurs according to the customary order [of causes], or because it is inflicted in defence.[129]

§669 In [pain] that contains benefit, gracious assistance [اللطف] is also necessary. §670 Where [pain] is deserved, it may be punishment [العقاب]. §671 Gracious assistance [اللطف] alone does not suffice for the goodness [الحسن] of pain inflicted upon an obligated person [المكلف]. §672 Nor is [pain] good when pleasure would provide its [same] gracious assistance [اللطف]. §673 The actual choice of the person suffering is not a condition of [the pain's] goodness [الحسن].

Compensation

§674 Compensation [العوض] (ʿiwaḍ) is a deserved benefit devoid of honour and exaltation.[130]

§675 It is owed by Him, exalted is He, through inflicting pains, depriving [someone] of benefits for another's advantage, and inflicting grief, whether it arises from immediate knowledge [العلم الضروري], acquired knowledge [العلم المكتسب] or probable judgment [الظن], but not when it arises from the servant's own act; and through His commanding His servants to cause harm or permitting it, and enabling nonrational [creatures to cause harm]. §676 This differs from burning upon [someone's] being cast into fire, and killing on the basis of false testimony.[131] §677 Securing redress [الانتصاف] is obligatory upon Him, exalted is He, by reason [العقل] and transmitted revelation [السمع]. §678 It is therefore impermissible to enable a wrongdoer to inflict wrong without [his already possessing an entitlement to] compensation [العوض] commensurate with his wrongdoing.[132]

§679 If the wronged person belongs among the people of Paradise, God, exalted is He, distributes his compensation [العوض] over different times, or graciously grants him its like. If he belongs among those punished, He deducts through it a portion of his punishment [العقاب], so that the alleviation is not apparent to him, by distributing the deducted amount over different times. §680 Its permanence is not obligatory: an excess [of benefit] for which the pain would be chosen is good even if it comes to an end. Nor must it occur in this world, since delaying it may serve a benefit. [The claim that] its cessation causes pain is denied; moreover, that lies outside the point at issue.

§681 It is not obligatory to make its recipient aware that it is being delivered as compensation [العوض]. §682 Its benefits are not confined to any particular [kind].

§683 It cannot validly be waived.[133]

[129] §668. Al-Ḥillī places this discussion after gracious assistance [اللطف] because pains and illnesses may figure among the circumstances affecting moral action. He distinguishes grounds on which pain can be good: desert, a greater benefit, avoidance of greater harm, the maintenance of a customary causal order, and defence. 'Customary' refers to his example of burning when someone is cast into fire; it does not mean that suffering becomes good merely through frequency. The following clauses impose further conditions on undeserved pain inflicted by God for benefit. It must also provide gracious assistance, and that assistance alone does not replace compensation [العوض] for the sufferer. The text also rejects inflicting pain where pleasure would supply the same assistance. Al-Ḥillī records disagreement among earlier theologians over these conditions, so the list is part of a disputed account of divine justice [العدل], rather than an undifferentiated approval of suffering. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 329–332.)

[130] §674. The definition distinguishes three forms of benefit. A gift or favour is not owed; compensation [العوض] is owed because of suffering or loss; reward [الثواب] is owed together with honour for meritorious action. Al-Ḥillī therefore excludes honour from compensation's defining character. This difference explains several later rulings: the compensatory benefit need not last forever, need not be identified by its recipient as compensation, and need not take one fixed form. Its purpose may be fulfilled by a benefit the recipient enjoys without knowing the reason it is given. Al-Ḥillī also distinguishes compensation owed by God from restitution owed by a human wrongdoer. The former must exceed the pain enough that every rational person would choose the compensated suffering; the latter equals the injury or loss. Paying that human liability does not make the original injustice [الظلم] good. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 332, 336–339.)

[131] §676. Al-Ḥillī explains that compensation [العوض] in these examples is owed by the person who casts the victim into the fire, or by the false witnesses, rather than by God.

[132] §678. The wrongdoer's compensatory entitlement, accrued through suffering, supplies what may be transferred to the injured party in divine redress. 'At that time' is rendered by 'already'; the proposition is not that every earthly wrong has already been visibly compensated.

[133] §683. The no-waiver clause occurs in the matn transmitted within al-Ḥillī's commentary but is absent from the corresponding main text of al-Jalālī's edition, p. 207, which proceeds directly to the amount of compensation [العوض]. Al-Ḥillī identifies the prohibition on waiver or gift with Abū Hāshim and the Qāḍī, then disagrees. He reports Abū al-Ḥusayn's allowance of a victim's releasing a human wrongdoer, while distinguishing a purported release of God, who gains nothing from it. Al-Ḥillī's own defence emphasizes that the compensation belongs to its recipient and can benefit another person through transfer. Even a compensatory claim against God can, he argues, be given to another human recipient. He contrasts reward [الثواب], which cannot be transferred because its accompanying honour must belong to the person who earned it. The commentary's disagreement and the textual variation should therefore remain visible. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 338.)

§684 Compensation [العوض] owed by Him, exalted is He, must exceed [the pain] to the point that every rational person would be content [to accept the pain for it]; compensation owed by us must be equal [to the injury].

Appointed terms

§685 A living creature's appointed term [الأجل] is the time when its life ends, as known to God Most High. §686 For someone killed, both [continued life and death] would have been possible had the killing not occurred. §687 The appointed term [الأجل] may be gracious assistance [اللطف] for another, but not for the obligated person [المكلف] [whose term it is].

Provision

§688 Provision [الرزق] is that from which benefit may legitimately be taken and from which no one is entitled to exclude [the recipient]. §689 Striving to obtain it may be obligatory, recommended, permissible or forbidden.

Prices

§690 Price is the assessment of the countervalue for which something is sold. It is low or high; customary practice and sameness of time and place must be considered. It depends upon Him, exalted is He, and also upon us.

What is most beneficial

§691 What is most beneficial [الأصلح] is obligatory in some circumstances, owing to the presence of the motive [الداعي] and the absence of a dissuading factor.[134]

[134] §691. Al-Ḥillī identifies this qualified position with Abū al-Ḥusayn al-Baṣrī and states that Ṭūsī adopts it; the claim is neither unrestricted obligation nor merely uncertainty about whether an obligation exists.

Division 4
Prophecy

The benefits of prophetic mission

§692 The sending of prophets [البعثة] is good because it comprises benefits: reinforcing reason [العقل] in what reason indicates; learning the judgement concerning what reason does not indicate; removing fear; learning what is good and bad, beneficial and harmful; preserving the human species and perfecting its individuals according to their differing dispositions; teaching them recondite crafts, moral character, and the governance of human affairs; and informing them of punishment [العقاب] and reward [الثواب]. Thus gracious assistance [اللطف] (luṭf) is provided to the morally responsible person [المكلف]. §693 The Brahmins' objection is invalidated by what has preceded.

The obligation of prophetic mission

§694 It is obligatory because it comprises gracious assistance [اللطف] in fulfilling the obligations known by reason.

The qualities required of prophets

§695 A prophet must be protected from error and sin [العصمة] ('iṣma), so that confidence [in him] may be secured and the purpose [of his mission] thereby achieved; also because [without such protection] following him and its contrary would both be obligatory, and it would be obligatory to censure him.[135]

§696 [He must also possess] perfection of intellect [العقل], intelligence, discernment, and sound judgement; and freedom from inadvertence and from everything that would repel people from him: baseness of fathers, unchastity of mothers, harshness, coarseness, the condition of desiring receptive anal intercourse (ubna) and similar conditions, eating in the road, and similar conduct.[136]

Miracles and prophetic truthfulness

§697 The way to know his truthfulness [الصدق] is the manifestation of a miracle [المعجزة] at his hand: the occurrence of something uncustomary, or the nonoccurrence of something customary, with a breach of customary order [خرق العادة] and correspondence to the claim.[137]

Extraordinary signs outside prophetic claims

§698 The story of Mary and other such stories establish the possibility [الإمكان] of its manifestation at the hands of the righteous. §699 This does not entail its ceasing to be miraculous, repelling people [from prophets], failure to distinguish [the prophet], invalidation of its evidentiary force, or its universal occurrence [for every truthful person]. §700 His miracles [المعجزة]—peace be upon him—before prophethood [النبوة] establish [the possibility [الإمكان] of] preparatory signs [الإرهاص] (irhāṣ). §701 The story of Musaylima and that of Abraham's Pharaoh establish the possibility [الإمكان] of manifesting a miracle [المعجزة] contrary [to a claimant's claim].[138]

The continuing need for prophetic guidance

§702 The proof of the obligation [to send prophets] establishes its universality [throughout time].[139] §703 A revealed law [الشريعة] is not required [for every prophetic mission].[140]

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[135] §695. Al-Ḥillī presents protection from sin [العصمة] as a condition of a prophetic mission's achieving its purpose. If the audience thought the prophet could lie or disobey, they could question the commands, prohibitions, and actions they were required to follow, undermining confidence in the mission. The remaining phrases compress two further counterfactual arguments. If the prophet sinned, following him would be required because he is a prophet, while following that act would be forbidden because it is sinful. Moreover, the general duty to forbid wrongdoing would require censuring him, which al-Ḥillī connects with the prohibition on causing him harm. These are arguments for the author's Imami account of comprehensive protection, not a list of actual prophetic offences. Al-Ḥillī explicitly contrasts this position with views that permit certain lesser sins or inadvertent lapses. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 349.)

[136] §696. Ubna is a historical medical and sexual category, not a modern clinical diagnosis. Al-Ḥillī lists it among conditions regarded as repellent; al-Tahānawī, Kashshāf iṣṭilāḥāt al-funūn, s.v. al-ubna (1996 ed., I, p.90), explains its sexual sense. The translation retains the source's historical judgement. Primary dictionary text: https://islamport.com/l/mjm/5287/134.htm .

[137] §697. A miracle [المعجزة] can involve either an extraordinary occurrence or an extraordinary prevention: al-Ḥillī compares a staff's becoming a serpent with preventing a capable person from lifting a very small object. Correspondence to the claim matters. If someone promises to cure blindness but the blindness remains and deafness occurs instead, the event does not confirm the claim. Al-Ḥillī further requires that the community cannot match or approximate the sign, that it come from God or by His command, and that it be connected with the prophetic claim during the period of moral obligation [التكليف]. The subsequent discussion permits extraordinary signs among the righteous. Its distinction is that a sign confirms the truth of the claim joined to it: without a claim to prophecy [النبوة], an extraordinary event does not by itself establish prophethood. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 350–352.)

[138] §701. 'Abraham's Pharaoh' is the matn's expression; al-Ḥillī identifies the ruler as Nimrod. The point is an extraordinary event that exposes a false claimant by producing the opposite of what he announces.

[139] §702. Al-Ḥillī explains this as the requirement that no period be without a prophet's revealed dispensation; it does not state that a new prophet must appear at every moment.

[140] §703. Al-Ḥillī contrasts Abū 'Alī's allowance of a prophet sent to confirm what reason knows with Abū Hāshim's requirement that a prophet bring a revealed law [الشريعة]. The issue is whether such a law is

The prophethood of Muḥammad

§704 The manifestation of the miracle [المعجزة] of the Qur'ān and of other miracles, conjoined with the claim of our Prophet Muḥammad—God bless him and his family—indicates his prophethood [النبوة]. The challenge, together with failure [to meet it] despite the abundance of motives [الداعي] [to do so], indicates miraculous inimitability [الإعجاز]. The miracles transmitted with recurrent agreement in their common import [التواتر المعنوي] (tawātur maʿnawī) reinforce it.

§705 The Qur'ān's miraculous inimitability [الإعجاز] is said to derive from its eloquence; or from its manner of composition together with its eloquence; or from divine prevention [الصرفة] (ṣarfa). All are possible.[141]

Abrogation and changing benefits

§706 Abrogation [النسخ] follows considerations of benefit.
§707 It has occurred: some things permitted to Noah's predecessors were forbidden to him; circumcision was made obligatory after its postponement [had been allowed]; marriage to two sisters together was prohibited; and other rulings [were likewise changed]. §708 Their report from Moses—peace be upon him—prescribing perpetuity is fabricated; even if it were granted, it would not establish the intended meaning conclusively.[142]

The universality and rank of the prophets

§709 Transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates the universality of his prophethood [النبوة]—God bless him and his family and grant them peace. §710 He is superior to the angels, as are the other prophets—peace be upon them—because [within them] there is something opposed to the rational faculty, and they compel it to obey that faculty.

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required for every prophetic mission.

[141] §705. Al-Ḥillī reports three accounts of Qur'ānic inimitability [الإعجاز]. The first locates it in eloquence; the second combines eloquence with a distinctive manner of composition; the third is divine prevention [الصرفة], or ṣarfa, whereby God prevents the Arabs from producing a counterpart. The last account makes their inability itself the extraordinary divine intervention. Al-Ḥillī attributes it to al-Naẓẓām and al-Murtaḍā, and explains al-Murtaḍā's argument that the opponents could otherwise supply the individual words and combine them. He also records objections from defenders of eloquence, including their appeal to the Arabs' admiration for the Qur'ān's language. The closing words leave all three explanations possible. Neither the matn nor this explanation licenses replacing that suspended judgment with a definite endorsement of one theory. The question here concerns the source of the miracle [المعجزة]'s inimitability, within an already affirmed prophetic proof. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 357.)

[142] §708. The antecedent is the report invoked by opponents of abrogating Moses' law. The statement about fabrication is Ṭūsī's judgement.

Division 5
The imamate

The obligation to appoint an imam

§711 The imam is gracious assistance [اللطف] (luṭf); therefore God Most High is obliged to appoint him, so that the purpose [of moral obligation] [التكليف] may be achieved.

§712 The absence of harmful consequences is known, and rational persons know that this gracious assistance [اللطف] is confined to him. His existence [الوجود] is gracious assistance, and his exercise of authority is another; its absence is due to us.[143]

Protection from error and sin

§713 The impossibility of an infinite regress [التسلسل] requires his protection from error and sin [العصمة]. [This is also required] because he preserves the revealed law [الشريعة]; because, if he committed a sin, censuring him would be obligatory, contradicting the command to obey him and defeating the purpose of his appointment; and because [otherwise] his rank would fall below that of the least of the common people.

§714 Protection from error and sin [العصمة] does not conflict with power [القدرة] [to commit sin].[144]

Superiority and explicit designation

§715 The badness [القبح] of giving precedence to the inferior is known; and, where [candidates] are equal, there is no ground of preference. §716 Protection from error and sin [العصمة] requires explicit designation [النص], as does the conduct of [the Prophet]—peace be upon him.

Arguments for the imamate of ʿAlī

§717 Both [protection from error and sin [العصمة] and explicit designation] [النص] belong uniquely to ʿAlī—peace be upon him. §718 [There is] the unambiguous designation [النص الجلي] in his sayings, 'Greet him as Commander of the Faithful', 'You are the successor after me', and others. §719 Also His—Most High—saying, 'Your guardian is only God and His Messenger', to the end of the verse; the attributes [mentioned there] are found together only in ʿAlī—peace be upon him.[145] §720 Also the recurrently transmitted [المتواتر] report of Ghadīr. §721 Also the recurrently transmitted [المتواتر] report of the Station [of Aaron].[146]

§722 Also his appointing him as deputy over Medina, which extends generally by consensus [الإجماع]. §723 Also his saying —peace be upon him—"You are my brother, my legatee, my successor after me, and the adjudicator of [matters of] my religion"—with a kasra on the dāl [of dīnī].[147] §724 Also because he is superior, and the imamate [الإمامة] of an inferior person is rationally bad. §725 Also because miracles [المعجزة] appeared at his hand: uprooting the gate of Khaybar, conversing with the serpent, lifting the immense rock from the well, fighting the jinn, bringing back the sun, and others. He claimed the imamate [الإمامة]; therefore he was truthful. §726 Also because the others' prior unbelief [الكفر] disqualifies them for the imamate [الإمامة], leaving him—peace be upon him—as the one determined [for it].

§727 Also His—Most High—saying, 'Be with the truthful.'[148] §728 Also His—Most High—saying, 'And those vested with authority among you.'[149]

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[143] §712. The final phrase concerns the absence of the imam's effective exercise of authority, as al-Ḥillī explains it; it does not assert the imam's nonexistence [العدم]. The objection asks how an imam can count as gracious assistance [اللطف] if he does not govern. Al-Ḥillī answers that his existence [الوجود] can preserve the law, and that belief in his existence and possible enforcement of its requirements can deter wrongdoing. His existence is also necessary for his exercise of authority. The commentary then divides the completion of this assistance among three responsibilities: God creates and equips the imam and designates him; the imam accepts the office; the subjects must support him and obey his commands. Al-Ḥillī says that the failure lies in this last responsibility. This explains both the distinction between two forms of assistance and the attribution of their incomplete realization to 'us'. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 362–364.)

[144] §714. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes accounts of protection that remove the ability to sin from accounts that preserve that ability. The latter explain protection through divine assistance, a stable disposition, or the absence of a motive [الداعي] to abandon obedience. In one account, the contributing factors are an established disposition against wrongdoing, knowledge [العلم] of the defects of sin and merits of obedience, reinforcement through revelation or inspiration, and correction even for neglecting what is better. These explanations must remain short of compulsion [الإلجاء]. Al-Ḥillī identifies Ṭūsī's position as preserving the protected person's power [القدرة] to sin. His argument is that without that power, abstention would not deserve praise or reward [الثواب], and the person would fall outside moral obligation [التكليف]. The claim is therefore that wrongdoing does not occur in the protected person, while the capacity relevant to moral responsibility remains. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 365–366.)

[145] §719. Qurʾān 5:55. Ṭūsī's argument depends on identifying the person described in the remainder of the verse with ʿAlī; the matn gives only this opening fragment.

[146] §721. The 'Station' report is the saying comparing ʿAlī's relation to Muḥammad with Aaron's relation to Moses, except for prophethood [النبوة] after Muḥammad; the source cites its title rather than quoting it.

[147] §723. The text deliberately reads dīnī ('my religion'), not daynī ('my debt'). Al-Ḥillī treats the phrase as explicit authority and succession.

[148] §727. Qurʾān 9:119.

[149] §728. Qurʾān 4:59.

Arguments against the competing claimants

§729 For the group apart from ʿAlī—peace be upon him—are unfit for the imamate [الإمامة], on account of their wrongdoing through their prior unbelief [الكفر].

Objections concerning Abū Bakr

§730 Abū Bakr contradicted the Book of God Most High by preventing inheritance from God's Messenger—God bless him and his family—on the basis of a report that he himself related. §731 He withheld Fadak from Fāṭima—peace be upon her—despite her claim that it had been given to her as a gift and the testimony of ʿAlī—peace be upon him—and Umm Ayman; yet he accepted the wives' claims that their rooms belonged to them. For this reason ʿUmar ibn ʿAbd al-ʿAzīz restored it. §732 She instructed that Abū Bakr should not perform the funeral prayer over her; she was therefore buried at night. §733 Also because of his saying, 'Release me [from office], for I am not the best of you while ʿAlī is among you.'

§734 Also because of his saying that a devil sometimes overtakes him. §735 Also because of ʿUmar's saying, 'The pledge to Abū Bakr was an unpremeditated occurrence whose evil God averted; whoever returns to anything like it, kill him.' §736 At his death he doubted his entitlement to the imamate [الإمامة]. §737 He contradicted the Messenger—God bless him and his family—by appointing a successor, according to their own account, and by appointing someone whom he—God bless him and his family—had dismissed.[150] §738 [He also contradicted him] by staying behind from Usāma's army, although they knew the intention was to send them away. [The Prophet] appointed Usāma over them, so Usāma is superior [to them]; whereas no one was appointed over ʿAlī—peace be upon him—and he is superior to Usāma.

§739 He held no office during his [the Prophet's] lifetime. [The Prophet] gave him Sūrat Barā'a, but Gabriel descended and instructed [the Prophet] to recall him and take the sūra from him, and that no one should recite it except himself or someone of his household. He therefore sent ʿAlī—peace be upon him—with it. §740 He did not know the legal rulings: he cut off a thief's left hand and burned [a man] with fire; he did not know [the ruling on] collateral inheritance (kalāla) or the grandmother's inheritance; his rulings were inconsistent; and he neither imposed the prescribed penalty on Khālid nor exacted retaliation from him.[151]

§741 He was buried in the house of God's Messenger—God bless him and his family—although God Most High had prohibited entering it without permission during his lifetime. He sent [men] to the house of the Commander of the Faithful—peace be upon him—when he refused the pledge, and had it set on fire while Fāṭima, al-Ḥasan, al-Ḥusayn, and a group of the Banū Hāshim were inside. Al-Ḥasan and al-Ḥusayn objected to him when allegiance was pledged to him; and he regretted violating the house of Fāṭima—peace be upon her.

Objections concerning ʿUmar

§742 ʿUmar ordered the stoning of a pregnant woman and of another woman who was insane. ʿAlī—peace be upon him—prevented him, and he said, 'Were it not for ʿAlī, ʿUmar would have perished.' §743 He doubted the Prophet's death—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—until Abū Bakr recited to him, 'You shall die, and they shall die.' He then said, 'It is as though I had never heard this verse.'[152] §744 He said, 'Everyone understands the law better than ʿUmar, even secluded women', when he prohibited excessive marriage payments. §745 He gave [public funds] to the Prophet's wives—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—borrowed [from those funds], and withheld from the People of the House—peace be upon them—their fifth.

§746 He issued a hundred rulings concerning [inheritance by] the grandfather, favoured some over others in distributions, and prohibited the two mutʿas.[153] §747 He decided the arrangements for the consultative council contrary to what was correct. §748 He tore up Fāṭima's document—peace be upon her.

Objections concerning ʿUthmān

§749 ʿUthmān appointed men whose transgression [الفسق] was evident, so that they introduced into Muslim affairs the innovations they introduced. §750 He preferred his relatives in the allocation of wealth. §751 He reserved grazing land for himself. §752 He committed reprehensible acts against the Companions: he beat Ibn Masʿūd until he died and burned his copy of the Qur'ān; he beat ʿAmmār

[150] §737. 'According to their own account' refers to the opponents' claim that the Prophet had appointed no successor. It is an argument from their premises, not Ṭūsī's own acceptance of that claim.

[151] §740. Al-Ḥillī identifies the person burned as al-Fujā'a al-Sulamī. The matn does not name him.

[152] §743. Qur'ān 39:30.

[153] §746. Al-Ḥillī identifies the two as temporary marriage and tamattuʿ in pilgrimage, the performance of ʿumra followed by ḥajj in the same pilgrimage season.

until he suffered a hernia; and he beat Abū Dharr and exiled him to al-Rabadha. §753 He waived retaliation against Ibn ʿUmar and the prescribed penalty against al-Walīd, although both were obligatory.

§754 The Companions abandoned him until he was killed. The Commander of the Faithful—peace be upon him—said, 'God killed him.' He was not buried until three days later, and they censured his absence from Badr, Uḥud, and the pledge [of al-Riḍwān].

The superiority of ʿAlī

§755 ʿAlī—peace be upon him—is superior because of his extensive striving in battle and his outstanding service in all the campaigns of the Prophet—God bless him and his family and grant them peace. No one attained his rank at Badr, Uḥud, the Day of the Confederates, Khaybar, Ḥunayn, and the other campaigns.

§756 Also because he is the most knowledgeable, owing to the strength [القوة] of his immediate insight and his close, constant attendance on the Messenger—God bless him and his family and grant them peace. The Companions referred to him in most cases after making mistakes. The Prophet—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—said, 'The best judge among you is ʿAlī.' The eminent masters of all the sciences traced their learning back to him, and he—peace be upon him—himself declared this. §757 Also His—Most High—saying, 'And ourselves.'[154] §758 Also because his generosity exceeded that of others. §759 He was the most ascetic of people after the Prophet—God bless him and his family and grant them peace. §760 And the most devoted in worship.

§761 And the most forbearing. §762 And the noblest in character. §763 And the earliest in faith [الإيمان]. §764 And the most eloquent. §765 And the soundest in judgement.

§766 And the most zealous to uphold the limits prescribed by God Most High. §767 And the most accomplished in memorising the Mighty Book. §768 Also because of his reports of the unseen. §769 And the answering of his supplication. §770 And the miracles [المعجزة] manifested through him.

§771 And his distinctive kinship [with the Prophet]. §772 And brotherhood [with him]. §773 And the obligation to love [him]. §774 And his support [of the Messenger]. §775 And his equality with the prophets.[155]

§776 And the reports of the Bird, the Station [of Aaron], Ghadīr, and others. §777 Also because no unbelief [الكفر] preceded [his faith] [الإيمان]. §778 Also because of the abundance of benefit derived from him. §779 And his distinction in perfections of soul [النفس], body, and external circumstances.

The eleven subsequent imams

§780 Recurrently transmitted [المتواتر] reports indicate [the imamate [الإمامة] of] the eleven; also [it follows] from the necessity [الوجوب] of protection from error and sin [العصمة], its absence in others, and the presence of perfections in them.[156]

Judgements concerning opponents

§781 Those who wage war against ʿAlī—peace be upon him—are unbelievers; those who oppose him [in the imamate] [الإمامة] are transgressors.[157]

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[154] §757. Qur'ān 3:61; the argument identifies ʿAlī with the person included under 'ourselves' in the mutual-imprecation verse.

[155] §775. Al-Ḥillī interprets this through a report comparing particular virtues of ʿAlī with those of Adam, Noah, Abraham, Moses, and Jesus, rather than asserting that he possesses prophethood [النبوة].

[156] §780. The eleven are the imams after ʿAlī. Al-Ḥillī enumerates al-Ḥasan, al-Ḥusayn, ʿAlī Zayn al-ʿĀbidīn, Muḥammad al-Bāqir, Jaʿfar al-Ṣādiq, Mūsā al-Kāẓim, ʿAlī al-Riḍā, Muḥammad al-Jawād, ʿAlī al-Hādī, al-Ḥasan al-ʿAskarī, and the Awaited Imam.

[157] §781. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes armed opposition to ʿAlī from opposition to his imamate [الإمامة]. For the first judgment he cites a report equating war against ʿAlī with war against the Prophet. For the second, he explicitly records disagreement among Imami scholars: some classify opponents as unbelievers for rejecting what they regard as a manifest and widely transmitted designation, while others classify them as transgressors. Al-Ḥillī calls the latter position stronger. He then records further disagreement about their eventual fate: permanent punishment [العقاب], subsequent entry into Paradise, or release from punishment without entry into Paradise, since the last account denies them both the unbelief [الكفر] warranting endless punishment and the faith [الإيمان] warranting reward [الثواب]. These alternatives are reported as positions within that discussion; the lemma does not decide between all of them. Its classifications are the author's doctrinal judgments, and the commentary's own distinctions should be retained when reading the surrounding polemical arguments about succession. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 398.)

Division 6
The return, the promise, the threat, and related matters

The possibility of another world

§782 The same judgement applies to two things that are alike; transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates the possibility [الإمكان] of a counterpart [to this world]. §783 Sphericity [as a necessary feature of another world], the necessity [الوجوب] of a void, and a divergence between things alike [in nature] are not conceded.[158]

The world and nonexistence

§784 Contingency [الإمكان] allows nonexistence [العدم] [of the world]. §785 Transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates its [actual] occurrence. §786 For the morally responsible person [المكلف], this is interpreted as the dispersal [of bodily parts], as in the story of Abraham—peace be upon him.[159]

Against treating annihilation as an entity

§787 Positing annihilation [الفناء] [as a distinct existent] is unintelligible: if it subsisted by itself it would not be a contrary [to substance] [الجوهر]; and the same is true if it subsisted in a substance. §788 Also because there is no ground of priority [for its annihilating the substance [الجوهر] rather than the substance excluding it]. §789 Also because it entails either a reversal of essential natures or an infinite regress [التسلسل].

Against treating persistence as an added entity

§790 Positing persistence [البقاء] (baqā') outside a substrate [المحل] entails either preference without a determining ground or the conjunction of contradictories. §791 Positing it within a substrate [المحل] entails a thing's dependence on itself, either immediately or through an intermediary.

Bodily resurrection

§792 The obligation to fulfil the promise, and wisdom [الحكمة], require resurrection [البعث]. It is known without inference [الضرورة] that bodily [resurrection] [المعاد الجسماني] belongs to the religion of the Prophet—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—and it is possible.

§793 It is not necessary to restore the morally responsible person [المكلف]'s superadded [bodily] parts.[160]

§794 [Arguments from] the claim that the celestial spheres cannot be ruptured, Paradise's being above them, the persistence of life during burning, the generation of the body without procreation, and the finitude of bodily capacities [القوى الجسمانية] are merely appeals to improbability.

Deserving reward and punishment

§795 Reward [الثواب] and praise are deserved for performing the obligatory and the recommended, performing the contrary of what is bad, and omitting the bad—provided that the obligatory is done because it is obligatory or because of the ground of its obligatoriness; the recommended likewise; the contrary [of the bad] because it is abstention from the bad; and its omission because it is such an omission. For hardship without compensation [العوض] is injustice [الظلم]; and, if [the benefit] could be bestowed initially [without the obligation], [imposing the obligation] would be purposeless.[161] §796 Likewise punishment [العقاب] and blame are deserved for doing what is bad and omitting what is obligatory, because [the prospect of punishment] provides gracious assistance [اللطف] and because of transmitted revelation [السمع].[162]

§797 There is nothing improbable in simultaneously deserving [praise and blame] in different respects.[163]

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[158] §783. These are premises of objections to another world. 'Not conceded' denies their necessity [الوجوب] in the argument, rather than simply asserting that the present heavens are not spherical.

[159] §786. The dispersal account preserves the identity of what will be reassembled. Al-Ḥillī explicitly relates it to the earlier rejection of the restoration of what has become absolutely nonexistent, and to Qur'ān 2:260.

[160] §793. Al-Ḥillī explains the clause through a distinction between original bodily parts and additions acquired through growth and nourishment. His stated requirement for resurrection is the restoration of the original parts, or of an immaterial soul [النفس] together with those parts, according to the account of the morally responsible subject. He then presents objections based on changing bodily matter. If one person consumes another, how could the same material be restored to both? And if every part acquired during life returned, the resulting body would be enormous and some matter would belong to different organs. The answer he develops treats a person's original parts as enduring throughout life; if consumed by someone else, they count only as additions in that second body. The lemma depends on this account of bodily identity, which supplies the premises of its answer. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 406–407.)

[161] §795. The distinction between performing a contrary and mere omission is deliberate. The closing argument distinguishes reward [الثواب] accompanied by deserved honour from a benefit that could simply be bestowed without prior obedience; al-Ḥillī explains both points.

[162] §796. Al-Ḥillī explains that knowing one deserves punishment [العقاب] for disobedience deters the obligated person [المكلف] from it and brings that person nearer to obedience. The gracious assistance [اللطف] concerns that deterrent prospect.

[163] §797. Here the 'two deserts' are praise and blame, as the particular objection in al-Ḥillī's explanation makes clear. The preceding

§798 Imposing hardship as gratitude for a benefit is bad. §799 Also because reason [العقل] judges it [gratitude] obligatory despite ignorance [of revealed obligations].[164] §800 Deserving reward [الثواب] requires that the act or omission be difficult; it does not require the absence of regret for having performed it, nor the absence of immediate benefit, if it was performed for the relevant ground.[165]

The attributes of reward and punishment

§801 Reward [الثواب] must be accompanied by honour, and punishment [العقاب] by humiliation, because it is known without inference [العلم الضروري] that both are deserved when the acts that warrant them are performed. §802 Both must endure perpetually, because this provides gracious assistance [اللطف], because praise and blame endure, and because their opposites would occur without it.[166] §803 Both must be unmixed [with their opposites]. Otherwise reward [الثواب] would be inferior to compensation [العوض] and gratuitous favour [التفضل], supposing such purity in those two; and [unmixed punishment] [العقاب] is more effective as a deterrent.

§804 Everyone who has a rank in Paradise desires no higher one. Their delight in gratitude reaches the point at which hardship disappears; their reward [الثواب] frees them from need and thus removes the difficulty of abstaining from bad acts. The people of the Fire are compelled to refrain from the bad.

The conditions of reward

§805 Reward [الثواب] may depend on a condition; otherwise the person who knows only God Most High would be rewarded [without accepting His messenger]. §806 It is conditioned on final perseverance [الموافاة] (muwāfāt), because of His—Most High—saying, 'If you associate partners [with God], your work will surely be nullified', and His saying, 'Whoever among you turns back from his religion'.[167]

The cancellation of merits and demerits

§807 Nullification [الإحباط] [of reward [الثواب] by subsequent sin] is false, because it entails injustice [الظلم], and because of His—Most High—saying, 'Whoever does an atom's weight of good will see it.'[168]

§808 Also because there is no ground of priority when one is twice the other, and because contradictories result when they are equal.[169]

The punishment of grave sinners

§809 The unbeliever remains forever [in punishment] [العقاب]; the punishment of the perpetrator of a grave sin [الكبيرة] comes to an end, because he deserves reward [الثواب] through his faith [الإيمان], and because [endless punishment in his case] is bad in the judgement of rational persons.[170]

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discussion distinguishes positively doing the contrary of a bad act from simply omitting that act, and likewise considers whether omission of a duty deserves blame. An opponent argues that if omissions can ground both judgments, a person who performs neither the duty nor the bad act would deserve praise and blame together. The reply is that the grounds differ: the person is praised for one omission and blamed for the other. Al-Ḥillī compares someone who obeys through one bodily member while sinning through another. Thus simultaneous moral assessments need not contradict each other when they concern different respects. The sentence is a reply to this objection about omission, rather than an assertion that opposed assessments hold in the same respect. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 407–409.)

[164] §799. Al-Ḥillī treats this as a second objection to al-Balkhī's claim that revealed obligations are simply payment of gratitude for prior benefits and therefore earn no reward [الثواب].

[165] §800. Al-Ḥillī distinguishes initially deserving reward [الثواب] from retaining that desert: the absence of subsequent regret is not a condition of the first, although it is relevant to the second.

[166] §802. The scope of this general formulation is expressly qualified below: at §§809–810 Ṭūsī limits endless punishment [العقاب] to unbelief [الكفر] and rejects endless punishment for the believing perpetrator of a grave sin [الكبيرة].

[167] §806. Qur'ān 39:65 and 2:217. Muwāfāt concerns the final state in which one reaches death or the hereafter; the second cited verse continues by specifying death in unbelief [الكفر]. The matn quotes only its opening.

[168] §807. Al-Ḥillī describes two theories under discussion. Abū 'Alī holds that a later act cancels the earlier desert while retaining its own effect. Abū Hāshim instead offsets the smaller amount against an equal portion of the larger, leaving the excess. The author rejects treating someone who has both obeyed and disobeyed as equivalent to someone who has done only one, or neither. Al-Ḥillī calls this unjust and invokes Qur'ān 99:7–8, of which the matn quotes the first verse's promise concerning even an atom's weight of good. The next lemma separately attacks Abū Hāshim's arithmetic model. This discussion should also be read with the preceding condition of final perseverance [الموافاة]: al-Ḥillī there distinguishes a condition governing reward [الثواب] from the cancellation of reward after it has been established. The immediate target here is the proposed mutual cancellation of moral deserts. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 412–414.)

[169] §808. Al-Ḥillī's example is five units of reward [الثواب] and ten of punishment [العقاب]: which equal half of the latter should the former cancel? If the two totals are equal, simultaneous mutual cancellation is alleged to require each to act while nonexistent. This explains the compressed objections without endorsing their validity.

[170] §809. The person who commits a grave sin [الكبيرة] in this argument is a Muslim who retains faith [الإيمان]. Al-Ḥillī's first proof begins from the reward [الثواب] deserved through that faith. Since he has already argued that such reward is enduring, it cannot be exhausted before punishment [العقاب] begins; where both are received, punishment must

§810 The transmitted texts [السمعيات] [cited against this] are subject to interpretation; perpetual punishment [العقاب] belongs exclusively to the unbeliever.

Divine pardon

§811 Pardon [العفو] occurs. For [punishment] [العقاب] is His—Most High—right and may therefore be waived; abandoning it causes Him no harm, while it harms the one on whom it descends, so waiving it is good; and it is an act of beneficence [الإحسان]. §812 Also because of transmitted revelation [السمع].

Intercession

§813 There is consensus [الإجماع] concerning intercession [الشفاعة]. It has been said to consist in increasing benefits, but [confining it to this] is refuted by our [prayers] on his behalf—God bless him and his family and grant them peace.[171] §814 Denying an [intercessor] who is obeyed does not entail denying one whose petition is answered. The remaining transmitted texts [السمعيات] [of denial] are interpreted as concerning unbelievers.

§815 It has also been said to consist in removing harms. The truth is that 'intercession [الشفاعة]' applies to both, and that the second is established for him—God bless him and his family and grant them peace—by his saying, 'I have reserved my intercession for the perpetrators of grave sins [الكبيرة] among my community.'[172]

The obligation and intention of repentance

§816 Repentance [التوبة] is obligatory because it averts harm, and because remorse for every bad act or omission of an obligation is obligatory. §817 One must regret the bad because it is bad; otherwise repentance [التوبة] is absent. If fear of the Fire is the ultimate aim, the same applies; likewise with omission [of an obligation].

Repentance from some sins

§818 It therefore cannot be valid for some [bad acts alone]; and the analogy with performing an obligation does not hold.[173] §819 But if he believes [the unrepented act] to be good, it is valid. §820 The same applies when an [unrepented] wrong is regarded as negligible [beside the graver wrong repented of].[174]

§821 The correct analysis is that a preponderant motive [الداعي] for remorse over some [bad acts] brings it about, although the motive for regretting the bad is shared, just as with motives for action. If the preponderance were shared, the occurrence of remorse would also be shared. The words of the Commander of the Faithful and his descendants—peace be upon them—are to be interpreted accordingly. Otherwise one would have to judge unbelief [الكفر] to persist in a person who repents of it while continuing in a minor sin.[175]

Repentance and outstanding obligations

§822 If a sin against His—Most High—right consists in a bad act, remorse and resolve [not to return to it] suffice. For omitting an obligation, the ruling differs according to

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therefore precede the lasting reward and come to an end. His second proof appeals to rational moral judgment: he rejects equating lifelong obedience followed by one grave offence, with faith preserved, to lifelong unbelief [الكفر]. Al-Ḥillī reports disagreement over this conclusion, identifying it as the Imami position and one also held by other theologians. The next lemma answers scriptural objections by restricting certain threats to unbelievers or interpreting the relevant expressions of abiding as prolonged rather than endless duration. The restriction to a sinner whose faith remains is essential to both proofs. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 414–415.)

[171] §813. The objection is that prayers asking God to raise the Prophet's rank would then make ordinary believers his intercessors. The next two lemmata develop the competing account and Ṭūsī's conclusion.

[172] §815. The two senses of intercession [الشفاعة] are seeking additional benefits and seeking the removal of harms. Al-Ḥillī explains that ordinary usage permits both, while the author expressly affirms the Prophet's intercession for grave sinners through the report cited in the lemma. The preceding argument rejects confining intercession to increased reward [الثواب]: if every prayer for greater benefit constituted such intercession, ordinary believers asking for the Prophet's higher rank would become his intercessors. He rejects this because he regards the intercessor as superior to the beneficiary. Another preceding distinction concerns a scriptural denial of an intercessor who is 'obeyed'. Al-Ḥillī argues that an answered petition does not make its petitioner superior to God or place God under that petitioner's command. The commentary thus connects relief from deserved punishment [العقاب] with a divine response to intercession, while preserving the distinction between answering a request and obeying an authority. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 416–417.)

[173] §818. This is the argument considered before Ṭūsī's own more discriminating resolution at §821. That resolution must be read with the present clause.

[174] §820. The clause concerns repentance [التوبة] from a grave wrong while a much lesser wrong remains unrepented. Al-Ḥillī still states that remorse for all one's wrongdoing is required.

[175] §821. This is the author's qualified resolution after the argument against partial repentance [التوبة] in §818. Al-Ḥillī explains that the badness [القبح] common to several acts can supply a reason to regret all of them, while further considerations make the motive [الداعي] stronger for one act: its gravity, repeated warnings against it, or the condemnation it attracts. Actual remorse may therefore arise for that act without yet arising for every other wrong. If the motives are equally strong, the same distinction cannot be made. Al-Ḥillī interprets reported statements of 'Alī and his descendants against partial repentance within this qualification. He also argues from the accepted conversion of someone who abandons unbelief [الكفر] while continuing a lesser sin. The conclusion permits partial repentance without denying the obligation to regret all wrongdoing, which the discussion has already affirmed. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 417–421.)

whether [the obligation] remains due, requires later performance, or neither. If the sin concerns a human being's right, it is followed by restoring that right when it was an injustice [الظلم]—or resolving to restore it when unable—or by giving guidance when it was misguidance. These are not constituent parts [of repentance] [التوبة].[176]

§823 One must apologize to the person one has backbitten when [the backbiting] has come to his attention.

Disputed requirements of repentance

§824 There is difficulty concerning the requirement [to repent] in detail when [the sins] are remembered. §825 There is also difficulty concerning the obligation to renew [repentance [التوبة] when a sin is remembered again]. §826 Likewise concerning [repentance [التوبة] for] the effect together with its cause [before the effect has occurred].[177]

§827 And [likewise, there is difficulty concerning] the necessity [الوجوب] of punishment [العقاب]'s being remitted through it.[178]

The effect of repentance

§828 Punishment [العقاب] is remitted through [repentance] [التوبة], not through the abundance of its reward [الثواب], since it may occur with [its reward] nullified. Otherwise there would be no difference between preceding and following [the sin], and no restriction [to the sin repented of]. It is not accepted in the hereafter because the condition is absent.[179]

The grave and the events of the return

§829 Punishment in the grave [عذاب القبر] occurs, because it is possible and because recurrently transmitted [المتواتر] revelation attests its occurrence. §830 The other matters received through revelation—the Balance, the Path, the Reckoning, and the flying forth of the records—are possible, and transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates their reality; they must therefore be affirmed.

Paradise and the Fire

§831 Transmitted revelation [السمع] indicates that Paradise and the Fire have already been created; the opposing texts are subject to interpretation.

Faith unbelief and transgression

§832 Faith [الإيمان] is assent [التصديق] by heart and tongue. The first alone does not suffice, because of His—Most High—saying, 'Their souls were certain of them', and similar texts; nor does the second alone, because of His saying, 'Say: You have not believed.'[180] §833 Unbelief [الكفر] is the absence of faith [الإيمان], whether accompanied by its contrary or not. Transgression [الفسق] (fisq) is departure from obedience to God Most High while retaining faith. Hypocrisy [النفاق] is displaying faith while concealing unbelief. §834 The transgressor is a believer, because the definition [of a believer] is realised in him.

Enjoining right and forbidding wrong

§835 Enjoining what is obligatorily right is obligatory, as is forbidding wrong. [Enjoining] what is recommended is recommended. [These rulings are established] by transmitted revelation [السمع]; otherwise either something contrary to actuality or a failure in His—Most High—wisdom [الحكمة] would follow.[181] §836 Their conditions are that the person undertaking them knows the relevant moral status, considers that they may be effective, and [anticipates] no harmful consequence.

Closing formula in al-Jalālī's edition

And God knows best what is correct.[182]

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[176] §822. The digital source reads ijzā' (إجزاء), but al-Jalālī, p.307, visibly prints ajzā' (أجزاء), 'parts', agreeing with al-Ḥillī's explanation. The translation follows this verified reading. The ensuing duties are distinguished from the definition of repentance [التوبة].

[177] §826. Al-Ḥillī's example is a person who has shot an arrow before it hits: must remorse concern the shooting, the anticipated injury, or both?

[178] §827. The Arabic continues the preceding 'there is difficulty'; al-Ḥillī explicitly says that Ṭūsī questions whether remission through repentance [التوبة] is obligatory. It must not be read as an independent assertion that such remission is necessarily owed; compare al-Jalālī, pp. 307–308. Al-Ḥillī reports agreement that repentance remits punishment [العقاب], with disagreement about why: the Mu'tazilites defend an obligation to remit it, while the opposing account treats remission as God's favour. He presents objections to arguments for obligatory remission, including the assumption that repentance is the only possible route to the removal of punishment and the analogy with accepting a human offender's apology. The following lemma nevertheless affirms remission through repentance when its conditions hold. It rejects explaining that remission by an excess of repentance's reward [الثواب] over punishment. The question left difficult here concerns obligation, not whether properly constituted repentance has the stated effect. (Al-Ḥillī, Kashf al-murād, Āmulī ed., pp. 422–424.)

[179] §828. The distinction is between repentance [التوبة]'s own effect, when its conditions hold, and an arithmetic excess of reward [الثواب] over punishment [العقاب]. Al-Ḥillī explains the absent condition in the hereafter by the compulsion of direct experience: the remorse is no longer chosen because the act is bad.

[180] §832. Qur'ān 27:14 and 49:14. The first fragment belongs to a verse describing outward denial despite inward certainty.

[181] §835. 'By transmitted revelation [السمع]' governs the obligation to enjoin and forbid. Al-Ḥillī explains the rejected rational argument as one that would impose the same duty on God in a way that either eliminates wrongdoing altogether or attributes neglected obligation to Him. This is not a denial that acts themselves have rationally knowable goodness [الحسن] and badness [القبح].

[182] Al-Jalālī, p.310, prints this formula in parentheses; his apparatus records its absence from witnesses bā' and dāl. It is absent from the

Terminology guide

The equivalents below follow the local usage of the text. A single Arabic word may require different English expressions in different arguments.

existence [الوجود] *wujūd*

The shared notion of being, distinguished from quiddity and divided into mental and external existence. §§2, 4, 5, 14, 16

nonexistence [العدم] *ʿadam*

Negation or absence of existence, considered absolutely or in relation to a specified thing or possession. §§28, 34, 35, 42

quiddity [الماهية] *māhiyya*

What answers "What is it?"; considered in itself, it carries no additional determination merely by being that quiddity. §§135, 138

essence; the thing itself [الذات] *dhāt*

The thing itself or its essence; §135 applies the term to quiddity with existence taken into account. §§70, 135, 254

reality; essential nature [الحقيقة] *ḥaqīqa*

A thing's reality or nature; §135 associates this term with quiddity regarded together with existence. §§135, 136, 398

establishment [الثبوت] *thubūt*

Establishment may be mental or external; §28 identifies the relevant sense with existence while rejecting an intermediate state. §§26, 28, 40, 57, 60

thingness [الشيئية] *shay iyya*

The consideration of something as a thing; treated as a secondary intelligible and coextensive with existence. §§23, 40

possibility; contingency [الإمكان] *imkān*

Intrinsic contingency excludes necessity of both existence and nonexistence; broader modal and dispositional senses are distinguished in the text. §§46, 53, 64, 73, 76

necessity; obligation [الوجوب] *wujūb*

Necessity in existence or in the connection of a predicate with its subject. Intrinsic necessity differs from necessity through another: a contingent thing may be necessitated by its cause without becoming necessary in itself. In moral and legal arguments, wujūb means obligation; it is not reserved for God's mode of existence. §§46, 61, 71–72, 74, 474, 650, 658, 792

impossibility [الامتناع] *imtināʿ*

Necessity of nonexistence, either in itself or through another; one of the three modalities alongside necessity and possibility. §§46, 50, 51, 58, 61

necessity; non-inferential or self-evident [الضرورة / الضروري] *ḍarūra / ḍarūrī*

In modal usage, ḍarūra includes both necessity and impossibility: necessary affirmation or existence, and necessary negation or nonexistence. It is therefore not exclusively a term for how something is known. In epistemic usage, ḍarūrī describes immediate or non-inferential knowledge, obtained without a deliberate process of proof. It does not mean a merely spontaneous belief, and correct conception may still be required. Al-Ḥillī's sixfold account includes sensory awareness and cognition involving implicit reasoning. Such knowledge can concern contingent facts; a necessary truth can conversely require demonstration. The epistemic division in §448 must be distinguished from the division of knowledge by its mode of existence in §449. §§51, 53, 69, 124, 438, 448–449, 452, 675

power [القدرة] *qudra*

The power to act, especially in voluntary agency. Rendered "power" to distinguish it from the several contextual senses of quwwa. This is an English translation convention; the Arabic semantic fields can overlap. §§24, 487, 491, 493, 576, 714

potentiality; faculty; capacity; force [القوة] *quwwa*

Potentiality when opposed to actuality; a faculty in psychology; a capacity in broader causal contexts; an acquired force in forced motion; and strength when describing the degree of an ability. A capacity can remain while exercised; potentiality opposed to actuality concerns what is not actual in the relevant respect. §§238, 304, 340, 343, 352, 516, 525, 557, 756, 794

analogical predication [التشكيك] *tashkīk*

Predication of a shared meaning with differences of priority or strength, as illustrated by existence, priority, and opposition. §§38, 79, 90, 189

eternity; beginninglessness [القدم] *qidam*

Being unpreceded by another or by nonexistence, according to the respect considered; essential and temporal questions must be distinguished. §§77, 82, 84

origination [الحدوث] *ḥudūth*

Being preceded by another or by nonexistence; essential origination and temporal coming-to-be are distinct considerations. §§77, 82, 83, 320, 323

substance [الجوهر] *jawhar*

A contingent existent not existing in a subject; this classification does not imply independence from every cause or from matter. §§253, 254, 258, 338

accident [العرض] *ʿaraḍ*

An existent in a subject; the discussion includes quantity, quality, and the other categories examined in Division II. §§253, 256, 376, 377, 390

subject [الموضوع] *mawḍūʿ*

A substrate subsisting independently of the accident it supports; in logic, the subject of predication. §§35, 36, 111, 253, 255, 256

controlling extracted matn and is therefore presented separately.

receptacle; substrate [المحل] *maḥall*

A receptacle for something inhering; broader than subject because it can include matter constituted by form. §§228, 231, 254, 255, 257

matter [المادة] *mādda*

The receptive factor in a composite; §284 rejects inferring matter additional to body from the body's divisibility. §§228, 254, 284

form [الصورة] *ṣūra*

The formal factor in a composite; also a mental representation or the arrangement of an inference, according to context. §§15, 231, 254, 441, 472

soul [النفس] *nafs*

The first perfection of a potentially living organic body; the rational soul's immateriality is argued separately. §§331, 338, 351, 352

intellect; reason [العقل] *ʿaql*

Can designate a separate immaterial substance or an intellectual disposition or faculty; the context determines which sense is intended. §§254, 327, 457, 458, 692

conception [التصور] *taṣawwur*

Apprehension of a thing without thereby affirming or denying a proposition; one of the two divisions of knowledge. §§124, 436, 438

assent [التصديق] *taṣdīq*

Affirmative or negative judgement; knowledge properly so called requires firm, corresponding, stable assent, and the term also appears in the definition of faith. §§3, 436, 438, 832

goodness; moral acceptability [الحسن] *ḥusn*

In §619 this broad category includes obligatory, recommended, permissible, and disliked acts: their performance does not merit blame. §§619, 620

badness; moral wrongness [القبح] *qubḥ*

Marks the blameworthiness of an act; the text argues that it can be known rationally, as with injustice. §§619, 620, 626, 796

gracious assistance [اللطف] *luṭf*

Assistance bringing the accountable agent nearer obedience or farther from wrongdoing while preserving choice; applied to prophecy and the imamate. §§658, 664, 692, 694, 711

moral obligation; imposition of obligation [التكليف] *taklīf*

The imposition of a known, demanding obligation on an agent; mukallaf is the person addressed by that obligation. §§474, 647, 650, 651

compensation [العوض] *ʿiwaḍ*

A deserved benefit without the honour accompanying reward; especially important in the argument about pain and wrongful injury. §§674, 675, 678, 684

reward [الثواب] *thawāb*

Deserved benefit for obedience, accompanied by honour; its grounds, conditions, and duration receive separate treatment. §§795, 800, 801, 802, 805, 806

punishment [العقاب] *ʿiqāb*

Deserved harm accompanied by humiliation; entitlement to it is distinguished from its execution, since pardon and intercession are admitted. §§796, 801, 811, 815

nullification [الإحباط] *iḥbāṭ*

The disputed cancellation of prior reward by later sin; its rejection is paired with separate conditions concerning final perseverance. §§806, 807, 808

return; resurrection [المعاد] *maʿād*

The eschatological return; bodily resurrection is defended through the reassembly of dispersed bodily parts. §§782, 786, 792, 793

protection from error and sin [العصمة] *ʿiṣma*

Protection required of prophets and the imam; the text expressly treats it as compatible with the power to sin. §§695, 713, 714, 716

relation; the relative [الإضافة / المضاف] *iḍāfa / muḍāf*

Relation itself is distinguished from the thing bearing it; its establishment is argued to be mental. §§514, 515, 516, 518

motion; change [الحركة] *ḥaraka*

The first perfection of what is potential as potential; discussed in quantity, quality, place, and position. §§525, 533, 538, 540, 541

Sources and editorial scope

Primary text. Naṣīr al Dīn al Ṭūsī, Tajrīd al iʿtiqād, as quoted in al ʿAllāma al Ḥillī, Kashf al murād fī sharḥ Tajrīd al iʿtiqād, edited and annotated by Ḥasan Ḥasanzāda Āmulī, Muʾassasat al Nashr al Islāmī. Rafed electronic edition, 646 pages. The translated matn occurs on pp.20–428. The continuous medieval commentary was used for interpretation; modern annotations beginning on p.429 were excluded from the translation corpus.

Comparison text. Naṣīr al Dīn al Ṭūsī, Tajrīd al iʿtiqād, edited by Muḥammad Jawād al Ḥusaynī al Jalālī. Qum: Markaz al Nashr, Maktab al Iʿlām al Islāmī, first edition, 1407 AH / 1986–87. Princeton University Libraries copy digitised by Arabic Collections Online. The matn runs from printed p.101 to p.310. Selected readings were checked, rather than every witness or every apparatus entry.

Terminological check. Muḥammad ʿAlī al Tahānawī, Kashshāf iṣṭilāḥāt al funūn wa al ʿulūm, 1996 edition, vol.1, p.90, entry ubna, was consulted for the historical term in §696. The glossary otherwise follows the local usage of the matn and al Ḥillī's explanations.

Modern translation identified. Sayyid Amjad H. Shah Naqavi, Theology Abstracted, an Arabic critical edition and English translation of Ṭūsī's Tajrīd al-iʿtiqād. London: The Shīʿah Institute Press, 2025. ISBN 9781917761000. The public preview, including the editorial introduction and selected Arabic and English passages, was consulted during revision. The complete book was not collated.

Assessment of editions. Al-Jalālī describes four manuscript witnesses and comparison with earlier commentaries (introduction, pp.76–85). Naqavi's preview identifies Tehran Majlis 9006/630, fols.65r–80v, as his base witness and discusses its audition note (introduction, pp.11–13). These are distinct editorial undertakings. Establishing a definitive text would require a full comparison of their evidence and apparatus; recency alone cannot settle the readings.

English style. Michael E. Marmura's introduction and conventions for Avicenna, The Metaphysics of The Healing (BYU Press, 2005), and a sample of his earlier translation of "On the Relative" were consulted as stylistic and editorial models. Jon McGinnis and David C. Reisman's translator preface to Classical Arabic Philosophy (Hackett, 2007, pp.xi–xii) also informed the balance between idiomatic English and visible ambiguity. These modern works guide presentation, not the interpretation of Ṭūsī's doctrines; their translations have not been copied into this text.

Arabic terminology. Selected technical senses were cross-checked against Jamīl Ṣalībā's al-Muʿjam al-falsafī and al-Tahānawī's Kashshāf iṣṭilāḥāt al-funūn wa-l-ʿulūm. These references clarify distinctions between related terms. Ṭūsī's Arabic and the local argument control the bracketed equivalents.

Jamīl Ṣalībā, al-Muʿjam al-falsafī. Entries consulted include imkān (I, pp. 134–135), ḍarūra (I, p. 757), māhiyya (II, pp. 314–315), mawḍūʿ (II, p. 447), qudra (II, p. 188), quwwa (II, p. 201), qadīm (II, p. 189), and sarmadī (I, p. 654). Online text.

Muḥammad ʿAlī al-Tahānawī, Kashshāf iṣṭilāḥāt al-funūn wa-l-ʿulūm. Entries consulted include wujūb, dhāt, ḥāll, iḍāfa, taklīf, ḥusn, qudra, and luṭf. Online text.

Textual limits. This volume translates the complete accessible recension embedded in al Ḥillī's commentary. It is not a newly constituted critical Arabic text, an exhaustive manuscript collation, or a translation of all commentaries. Notable differences from al Jalālī are identified at §§1, 312, 366, 496, 572, 579, 605, 636, 683, and 822, and at the separately identified closing formula. Some of these are transcription corrections or agreements in a sensitive reading, rather than divergent textual clauses.

Interpretive limits. Bracketed explanations usually follow the attached al Ḥillī commentary. Where he offers alternatives, disagrees with the matn, or where the supplied reading remains difficult, the relevant note says so. Later commentaries by al Iṣfahānī, al Jurjānī, al Qūshjī, and al Lāhījī have not been comprehensively collated for this version.

Rafed Arabic text

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Al Jalālī edition at Arabic Collections Online

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Marmura The Metaphysics of The Healing

Marmura On the Relative

McGinnis and Reisman Classical Arabic Philosophy

Al Tahānawī dictionary entry

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Page numbers come first; bracketed § references identify the numbered passages and remain the same in both editions. Entries locate the passage and its attached note, where present.

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